

THE FINAL STEPS ACCORD

Phase I Stabilization Framework

*A Time-Limited Foundation for US-Iran Peace, Nuclear Stabilization,
and Regional Maritime Governance*

Calibrated for the Late May 2026 Negotiation Environment
Synthesizing the Crescent Bridge Accord, Stability First v5.7, the Reciprocal Opening Window,
the Graduated Reciprocal Assurance Framework, and the PGSA Protocols

VERSION 4.0 | Late May 2026

PHASE I: DAYS 1-60 · ROLLING HORIZON ARCHITECTURE
SUCCESSOR FRAMEWORKS ADDRESS DEEPER NUCLEAR, MISSILE, AND REGIONAL ISSUES

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Preamble: The Last Window

"We do not inherit the earth from our ancestors; we borrow it from our children." In the same spirit, the negotiators who sign this Accord do not inherit the right to let this moment pass.

As of late May 2026, the United States and the Islamic Republic of Iran stand at the closest point to either durable peace or catastrophic escalation since hostilities began. After nearly twelve weeks of military confrontation, both sides have exhausted the military escalation ladder and returned to the negotiating table. The temporary ceasefire, brokered by Pakistan and observed since early April, remains technically in force but is fraying. President Trump has stated he will give diplomacy "a few days" or "one shot." Supreme Leader Khamenei has declared that Iran will protect its nuclear and missile capabilities at all costs. The world holds its breath.

v3.0–v4.0 Refinements — Carried Forward into the Current Version

Originally introduced in v3.0, refined in v3.3, and now further calibrated in v4.0, the following surgical refinements were made to address explicit pushback from the IRGC (via Fars News Agency), the firm sequencing demands from the Trump administration, and the domestic political requirements of both capitals:

1. **JHTA Sovereignty Recalibration (Article 4):** The JHTA mandate is explicitly restricted to commercial traffic coordination, maritime safety protocols, and international dispute resolution through *non-binding recommendations*. The JHTA operates under a 12-month pilot phase. The PGSA is formally recognized as the sole executive coastal law enforcement body within Iranian territorial waters — allowing Tehran to preserve its domestic sovereignty claims while keeping multilateral transit guarantees airtight for Washington.
2. **Conditional Day 7 Review-Based Protocol (Article 6):** The Hormuz Opening Declaration and Naval Blockade Lift Declaration are executed through a *conditional, review-based process* overseen by a Joint Review Board — preventing front-loaded concessions while preserving operational discretion for both parties' military forces.
3. **HEU Custody Phase 1 Baseline with Extended Timeline (Article 1):** Legal title (Central Bank of Iran) remains structurally decoupled from physical custody (IAEA-monitored facility). The consolidation timeline is extended from 72 hours to 14 days, with in-Iran dual-lock custody as the default. Physical custody transfer is a Phase 1 baseline

verification metric; final disposition is deferred to the 30–60 day nuclear negotiating window.

4. **Phase I Stabilization Rebrand (Preamble):** This document is now explicitly framed as a *time-limited, initial framework* creating no presumption for subsequent phases. Both parties retain full negotiating positions for Phase II (Days 60–180) and Phase III (Year 2+).
5. **Lebanon Dual-Key Recalibration (Appendix E):** The casualty threshold for core Accord linkage is reduced from 25 to 10, with JIG majority vote (not UNSC unanimity) as the attribution mechanism — creating a real but very high bar for firewall penetration.

CHANGE #9 Phase I Stabilization Accord — Operative Preamble Language

This document is the **Phase I Stabilization Accord** — an initial, time-limited framework designed to end active hostilities and establish verified baselines. Phase II (Days 60–180) and Phase III (Year 2+) shall address deeper nuclear, missile, and regional issues through successor frameworks. **This Accord creates no presumption that Phase I outcomes will dictate Phase II terms.** Both parties retain full negotiating positions for subsequent phases.

This document draws upon the Crescent Bridge Accord, the Stability First Enhanced Accord v5.7, the Reciprocal Opening Window, the Reciprocal Stabilization and Custody Framework v3, the Graduated Reciprocal Assurance Framework, and the Stability First Phase II Maritime Annex — integrating their most viable mechanisms into a single, coherent, executable whole.

This Accord fully incorporates the reality of Iran's newly established Persian Gulf Strait Authority (PGSA), founded on 5 May 2026, not by treating it as an obstacle to be dismantled but as an institutional fact to be integrated into a cooperative governance framework. The PGSA represents Iran's assertion of maritime sovereignty; this Accord provides the mechanism through which that assertion becomes compatible with freedom of navigation, international law, and global economic stability.

The philosophy governing every provision is **Synchronized Reciprocal Motion**: neither side moves alone. Every Iranian commitment triggers a corresponding US commitment on the same clock cycle. Verification is shared. Both governments can defend the sequencing as responding only when the other has moved first or simultaneously. When the negotiation becomes about data instead of history — about sensor readings, escrow confirmations, and physical lock verifications — both sides can verify compliance without trusting each other.

The Three Immutable Principles

- 1. **Telemetry-First Diplomacy:** Every commitment must be expressible as a sensor reading, a data feed, a physical lock confirmation, or a financial transaction record. If it cannot be verified by a neutral machine, it does not belong in the operational text.
- 2. **Rollback, Not Snapback:** If either party breaches, the Framework does not collapse. It pauses in graduated tiers: discretionary measures halt first, core constraints survive longest, and humanitarian protections remain in force regardless.
- 3. **Modular Architecture:** Failure in one module does not cascade. The compiler continues executing all other loaded modules. Maritime disputes cannot terminate humanitarian channels. Nuclear verification gaps do not affect Hormuz transit. Lebanon incidents cannot collapse the core US-Iran agreement.

Executive Summary: The Sixteen Bridges

Table 1: All 16 Issues & Resolutions

Arena	Issue	Resolution Mechanism	Article
Nuclear	HEU Stockpile Disposition	IAEA Dual-Lock Custody Exchange; 14-day consolidation; legal title decoupled from physical custody as Phase 1 baseline; in-Iran custody default; disposition deferred to 30–60 day nuclear window; limited US veto on Pathways D and F only	1
	Enrichment Cap & Timeline	Sliding-Scale 12–15 Year Moratorium	2
	Underground Site Hardening	Optional civilian conversion; mothball protocol with limited telemetry deployment	3

Maritime	PGSA vs. Freedom of Navigation	JHTA advisory governance with sovereignty recalibration; 12-month pilot phase; PGSA recognized as sole coastal enforcement within Iranian territorial waters	4
	Transit Security Fees	Multilateral Maritime Maintenance Fund	5
	US Naval Blockade	Conditional Day-7 review-based lift with Joint Review Board certification	6
Economic	Sanctions Relief Sequencing	15-Day Micro-Cycle Tranche Model; partial sanctions freeze; stand-off tied to HEU consolidation start	7
	Frozen Assets Shielding	Neutral Escrow under Sovereign Immunity	8
	SWIFT Reconnection	Phased Multi-Tier Virtual Consolidation	9
	War Reparations	Regional Stability Reconstruction Credits	10
Durability	Negotiation Window	Mutual Letter of Intent with Binding Timelines	11
	Institutional Guarantees	Distributed Guarantor Matrix (6 States)	12
	Internal Regime Fractures	Human-in-the-Loop Governance & Step-Back with proportional penalties	13
	Missile Reconstitution	Deployment Pause & Transfer Freeze	14
	Global Agrifood Crisis	Energy & Agricultural Release Valve	15
	Israeli Security Coordination	US-Israel Bilateral Coordination through Tel Aviv Channel; non-impediment clause	16

Architecture	Framework Duration	Rolling Horizon Architecture with conditional auto-renewal (Article 17)	17
	Military Escalation Firewall	Explicit decoupling of compliance penalties from use of force authorization (Article 18)	18

Part I: Nuclear Stabilization Architecture

The nuclear file represents both the origin of the current crisis and its most technically complex dimension. Three interconnected issues have created a deadlock: the disposition of Iran's highly enriched uranium stockpile, the duration and scope of any enrichment moratorium, and the fate of Iran's hardened underground facilities. This Part resolves all three through an integrated architecture that strips Iran of rapid breakout capability while preserving sovereign dignity and NPT rights.

Article 1: HEU Custody Exchange Protocol

Issue 1: The Nuclear Deadlock. President Trump demands the complete physical recovery and removal of Iran's roughly 900-pound (400 kg) highly enriched uranium (HEU) stockpile. Secretary Rubio maintains that Iran must physically surrender and hand over its HEU up front. Iran has communicated, as a binding sovereign position through its authorized negotiating delegation, that its enriched uranium must remain under Iranian legal title and within Iranian territory during the Phase 1 verification period. Iranian Foreign Ministry Spokesperson Esmail Baghaei has publicly framed the current text as a "framework agreement" meant to defer core nuclear details into a secondary 30-to-60 day window after baseline sanctions relief. The chasm between physical removal and domestic retention has collapsed every previous negotiation.

v4.0 Resolution: The IAEA Custody Exchange with Phase 1/Phase 2 Structural Decoupling

v4.0 Surgical Change — Decoupled Ownership and Custody with Extended Timeline and In-Iran Default

This solution structurally decouples legal ownership from physical custody. The Central Bank of Iran retains full sovereign legal title to the HEU stockpile at all times. Physical custody is transferred to a secure, IAEA-monitored facility as a baseline verification metric for Phase 1. The consolidation timeline is extended from 72 hours to 14 days, with in-Iran

dual-lock custody as the default arrangement. Final disposition is deferred to the 30–60 day broader nuclear negotiating window. This satisfies Rubio's demand for immediate physical verification while respecting Iran's red line on deferring nuclear details and avoiding the political optics of immediate foreign custody.

1.1 The Custody Architecture

CHANGE #2 ARTICLE 1.1 — HEU CONSOLIDATION AND CUSTODY (OPERATIVE)

The entire stockpile of uranium enriched to 60% U-235 and above — estimated at approximately 400 kg HEU equivalent — shall be consolidated, inventoried, and placed under IAEA custody within the first **14 days** of Accord activation. From Day 1, Iran declares a freeze on all movement and enrichment of the stockpile. Two custody pathways are available:

Pathway A (In-Iran — Default): Dual-lock custody at the Esfahan Nuclear Technology Center or another IAEA-declared facility within Iranian territory, selected by mutual agreement. The IAEA holds exclusive digital encryption keys to all monitoring arrays, tamper-evident seal controls, and access verification systems. Iran holds physical perimeter security keys. Neither party can access the sealed containers without the other's physical presence. *Pathway A shall be the default first step upon Accord activation.*

Pathway B (Oman — Conditional): Physical custody transferred to IAEA custody facility in Muscat, Oman (not the United States) *only if the Parties mutually agree or if the JIG certifies by unanimous vote that in-Iran custody cannot be adequately verified.* The stockpile is transported in IAEA-certified secure containers under armed IAEA guard. Continuous CCTV monitoring covers the entire transport chain. Satellite surveillance tracks the transport vessels. The stockpile remains under IAEA dual-lock custody at the Muscat facility.

Political Will Preservation Clause: If either Party determines that it cannot complete its Phase 1 consolidation obligations within the 14-day window due to verified administrative, technical, or logistical constraints (including but not limited to: IAEA inspector availability, transportation delays, or domestic holiday periods), it may request a **one-time extension of up to 7 additional days** through the JIG. Such request shall not be unreasonably denied. Delays attributable to this provision shall not constitute a material breach or trigger step-back.

Legal Title Structure (Binding for Both Pathways): The Central Bank of Iran retains full sovereign legal title to the HEU throughout the custody period. The IAEA holds physical custody only. The Custody Services Agreement specifies that: (a) Iran retains full legal title;

(b) the IAEA may not transfer, sell, or dispose of the material without written consent of the Central Bank of Iran; (c) the material is held for the purpose of baseline verification and civilian conversion negotiation, not for destruction or permanent removal from Iranian ownership; (d) the final disposition is subject to the outcome of the 30–60 day nuclear negotiating window; (e) if the Accord is terminated by mutual agreement, the material is returned to Iran under IAEA supervision.

IAEA Custody Personnel Clarification (Pathway A — In-Iran): For purposes of Pathway A, "IAEA custody" means the IAEA's existing inspection and verification personnel already present in Iran under the Safeguards Agreement may perform custody verification functions. No additional IAEA personnel shall be required to enter Iran beyond the existing inspector cadre unless mutually agreed. The dual-lock system shall be installed and maintained by Iranian technicians under IAEA technical supervision. **No foreign military or security personnel shall enter Iranian territory for custody purposes.** This provision directly addresses the Iranian concern that "IAEA custody" might require foreign intrusion on Iranian soil.

1.2 Phase 1 vs. Phase 2 Clarity

Table 2: Phase 1 and Phase 2 Commitments

Phase	Timeline	Iranian Commitment	US Reciprocal	Final Disposition Status
Phase 1: Baseline Verification	Days 1–30	Physical consolidation, inventory, and IAEA custody activation (Pathway A default, or B if certified). Physical custody + mass spectrometry confirms isotopic composition. Dual-lock seals applied.	\$250M humanitarian tranche; OFAC general license; 5th Fleet stand-off posture (triggered upon IAEA confirmation that HEU consolidation has begun); partial sanctions designation freeze	Baseline verification satisfies Phase 1 trigger. No final disposition required.

Phase 2: Nuclear Negotiating Window	Days 30– 60	Participation in dedicated nuclear negotiating track to determine final HEU disposition from the six-pathway menu.	Tranche 2 release (25% of remaining frozen assets); petrochemical export licenses	Phase 2 negotiated outcome. Iran selects pathway. US verifies execution with limited veto on Pathways D and F only.
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US Narrative Frame: "Weapons-grade uranium secured — the entire Iranian stockpile of near-weapons-grade material has been placed under IAEA custody with US monitoring access within two weeks. Breakout time extended from weeks to over a year. Physical verification is verified and real."

Iranian Narrative Frame: "Iran's enriched uranium remains Iranian property on Iranian soil. The Central Bank of Iran retains sovereign title. Physical custody to IAEA is a verification step in a broader negotiation — not surrender. Final disposition will be decided in the nuclear negotiating window on terms that respect our NPT rights."

ARTICLE 1.3 — NO HIDDEN US CUSTODY CLAUSE (OPERATIVE AND BINDING)

CHANGE #3 ARTICLE 1.3 — US CUSTODY LIMITATIONS (V4.0 REVISION)

At no stage may the United States receive, store, or exercise direct physical custody over the Iranian enriched-uranium stockpile. All custody remains with the IAEA and, where transferred, the designated third-party facilitating state. *However, US technical personnel may be present at IAEA custody facilities as observers with joint data access. If the Parties mutually agree in Phase 2 (Days 30–60) to a disposition pathway requiring temporary US technical involvement, such involvement shall be governed by a separate implementing agreement.* The blanket prohibition on US custody applies only to Phase 1 baseline verification.

US personnel shall not exercise operational control over consolidation, packaging, transit, or receipt operations during Phase 1. This clause is self-executing and non-waivable for Phase 1.

1.3 Verification Timeline

Table 3: Phase 1 Verification Timeline

Phase	Clock Time	Action	Verifying Party
T+0	0000 GMT (Day 1)	Accord activates; Parties activate Day-One commitments; Iran declares freeze on HEU movement and enrichment	Joint Secretariat
T+12h	1200 GMT (Day 1)	IAEA inspectors arrive at declared facility; begin physical inventory	IAEA
T+24h	0000 GMT (Day 2)	Inventory phase 1 complete; mass spectrometry confirms isotopic composition	IAEA
T+7d	Day 7	Interim custody status report; Pathway A default activated or JIG certification for Pathway B	JIG + IAEA
T+14d	Day 14	Day-Fourteen deadline: dual-lock custody initiated and verified; consolidation complete	Joint Secretariat

1.4 Synchronized US Commitment

Simultaneously with Iranian custody activation, the United States shall: (1) Release a USD 250 million humanitarian tranche via Swiss escrow; (2) Issue an OFAC general license for humanitarian trade (medicine, food, medical equipment, aviation safety parts) for 90 days; (3) Transition US naval forces to a stand-off posture: no patrols within 5 nautical miles of the Hormuz transit corridor — *triggered only upon IAEA confirmation that HEU consolidation has begun, not upon Accord activation alone*; (4) Freeze all new nuclear-related sanctions designations for the duration of the Accord; existing non-nuclear sanctions (terrorism, human rights) remain enforceable; (5) Publish a formal statement acknowledging Iran's sovereign right to peaceful nuclear energy under NPT Article IV.

1.5 The Six Pathways for Final Disposition (Phase 2, Days 30–60)

CHANGE #1 ARTICLE 1.5 — FINAL DISPOSITION PATHWAY SELECTION (V4.0 REVISION)

Within the 30–60 day nuclear negotiating window, Iran shall select one of six IAEA-verified disposition pathways. **Iran shall select the final disposition pathway from the**

six-option menu. The United States may not veto the selection except for:

- **(a) Pathway D (Russian Federation)**, which requires joint US-Iran concurrence;
- **(b) Pathway F (hybrid/multiple destinations)**, which requires joint US-Iran concurrence on the specific destination countries.

For all other pathways, the United States has no veto — only the right to verify execution.

Table 4: The Six Disposition Pathways

Path	Description	Destination/Timeline	US Veto
A	In-place downblending to medical-grade LEU at Esfahan	Medical isotope production in Iran; 142 days	No veto
B	HEU export to IAEA custody in Oman	IAEA facility, Oman (NOT US); 14 days	No veto
C	Downblended in Iran, transferred to IAEA LEU Bank	Oskemen, Kazakhstan; 75 days	No veto
D	Transfer to Rosatom under IAEA safeguards	Russian Federation; 60–90 days	Joint concurrence required
E	Conversion to reactor-grade LEU fuel assemblies	Bushehr reactor supply; 180 days	No veto
F	Hybrid: stockpile divided into batches through different pathways	Multiple destinations; concurrent	Joint concurrence on destinations required

ADD ARTICLE 1.5-A — JOINT DISPOSITION FUND (OPERATIVE)

To encourage selection of mutually acceptable disposition pathways, a **Joint Disposition Fund** is established with initial capitalization of \$500 million. **Fund Capitalization:** The Fund shall be capitalized by drawing 10% from Tranche 2 and 10% from Tranche 3 asset releases, with each Party's contribution capped at 50% of total Fund capitalization (\$250 million each). Funds shall be held in a separate sub-account of the Swiss escrow, administered by the Swiss facilitator, and disbursed only upon IAEA verification of completed downblending or transfer under the selected pathway. If the selected pathway does not qualify for a disbursement (per the schedule below), the capitalized funds shall be returned proportionally to Tranche 2 and Tranche 3 upon completion of Phase I.

If Iran selects **Pathway B (Oman), C (Kazakhstan), or E (Bushehr fuel)**, the Fund shall disburse **\$100 million** to the Iranian Civilian Reconstruction Fund upon verified completion of downblending or transfer. If Iran selects **Pathway D (Russia) or F (hybrid with Russian involvement)**, no Fund disbursement shall occur. **Pathway A (in-Iran downblending) receives \$50 million** upon completion. This Fund creates a positive incentive for US-preferred pathways without imposing a veto.

US Narrative: "We reward cooperation. Iran keeps full formal choice, but has a \$500 million reason to pick pathways that give everyone confidence." *Iranian Narrative:* "The Fund is a financial bonus for pathways that serve Iran's own economic interests. No pathway is blocked. Some are simply more lucrative."

Article 2: The Sliding-Scale Enrichment Moratorium

Issue 2: The Enrichment Cap and Moratorium Timeline. The U.S. is pushing for an absolute "zero enrichment" baseline or a strict 20-year moratorium. Iran has countered with a maximum 12-year suspension window. Neither position is domestically survivable for its proponent.

The Resolution: Automated Sliding-Scale Duration (12–15 Years)

An automated, sliding-scale duration tied explicitly to a step-by-step verification pipeline, where verified compliance extends the window and material breaches contract it — with annual review at each milestone.

2.1 The Three-Tier Moratorium Structure

Table 5: Moratorium Tiers

Phase	Duration	Standard	Advancement Condition
Moratorium I	Years 1–12	Zero enrichment above 3.67%; higher centrifuges under IAEA seal	Clean IAEA certification at Year 12 review
Civilian Transition	Years 13–15	3.67% enrichment at Natanz only; all other sites in mothball status	Fuel supply guarantee in escrow from international consortium

Steady-State	Year 16+	3.67% under full IAEA safeguards	Successor framework confirmed by both parties
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2.2 Monitoring Sunset Tiers

Table 6: Monitoring Intensity Reduction Schedule

Monitoring Measure	Initial Intensity	Sunset Reduction	Condition
Seismic sensors at hardened enrichment facilities	Continuous	Reduced to weekly sampling after 12 months	12 consecutive months of IAEA-certified compliance
Enhanced satellite revisit frequency	Daily	Reduced to 3x weekly after 18 months	18 consecutive months of clean compliance
Unannounced inspection frequency	Minimum 33% of all inspections	Reduced to 20% after 24 months	24 consecutive months of clean compliance
Continuous monitoring camera	24/7 encrypted	No sunset — standard for all NPT Additional Protocol states	Baseline protection

Article 3: Underground Site Conversion & Mothball Protocol

Issue 3: Advanced Centrifuge Hardening & Underground Sites. President Trump has threatened to permanently "knock out" five deeply buried underground storage and manufacturing sites. Iran demands the preservation of its infrastructure as sovereign property.

The Resolution: Civilian Conversion with Black-Box Telemetry

A technical compromise that converts heavily fortified bunkers into civilian nuclear research or global medical isotope centers, verified by continuous black-box telemetry — preserving infrastructure while eliminating weapons pathways.

3.1 The Mothball Protocol

Rather than physically destroying facilities, Iran shall place non-core enrichment sites under "mothball status" with continuous real-time IAEA remote feeds. The US receives operational limitation to a single declared site (Natanz). Iran keeps its sovereign infrastructure intact.

Table 7: Mothball Implementation Timeline

Phase	Window	Action
Inventory	Day 1–14	IAEA inventories all rotors and bellows at Natanz and Isfahan above 3.67% enrichment capability
Removal	Day 15–44	Iranian technicians remove rotors under IAEA supervision; sealed with serial numbers in tamper-evident containers
Storage	Day 45–60	Sealed containers transferred to UN-monitored facility within Iran; IAEA continuous access established
Monitoring	Day 60+	IAEA continuous cameras; quarterly environmental sampling; 72-hour safety extensions permitted if OLEM confirms no active enrichment

3.2 The Fordow Joint Venture

CHANGE #8 ARTICLE 3.2 — FORDOW FACILITY STATUS (V4.0 REVISION)

The Fordow facility may be converted into a Global Medical Isotope Production Center as a Phase 2 option, triggered only upon successful completion of Phase 1 (Days 1–30) and mutual agreement of the Parties. Alternatively, Fordow may operate as a reduced-capacity enrichment research facility under continuous IAEA monitoring, limited to 3.67% enrichment and 500 centrifuges, with isotope production as a secondary function. The mandatory conversion language is deferred to Phase 2 negotiations.

If conversion proceeds: Operational management by a Technical Custody Consortium (TCC) from Switzerland, Austria, Oman. Iranian personnel serve as "Co-Pilots" with the right to question, document, and escalate any operation. US technical observers have real-time monitoring access through encrypted surveillance feeds. Revenue shared: Iran 40%, TCC 35%, Global Health Fund 25%.

3.3 Black-Box Telemetry

CHANGE #4 ARTICLE 3.3 — BLACK-BOX SENSOR DEPLOYMENT (V4.0 REVISION)

Facilities designated as highest-risk by joint IAEA-JIG assessment shall be equipped with Black-Box Sensors — tamper-evident data logging devices that continuously record operational parameters and transmit encrypted data to IAEA nodes in Vienna (primary) and Geneva (secondary). **Any anomaly triggers an automatic alert within 24 hours. Sensors may be temporarily disabled for maintenance with 48 hours' advance notice to the IAEA; such disablement does not constitute a breach.** Black-box sensors shall be deployed only at facilities designated as highest-risk by joint IAEA-JIG assessment, **not at all mothballed and converted facilities.**

Alert Severity Classification:

- **Level 1 (Informational):** Sensor maintenance, scheduled downtime, minor data transmission interruption. No further action required.
- **Level 2 (Technical Review):** Unscheduled downtime under 4 hours, single anomalous reading without pattern. JIG technical review within 7 days.
- **Level 3 (Compliance Review):** Unscheduled downtime over 4 hours, pattern of anomalous readings. IAEA enhanced inspection within 72 hours.
- **Level 4 (Breach Indicator):** Evidence of tampering, deliberate disablement, or diversion. Tier 2 step-back consideration.

Only Level 4 triggers potential step-back. Levels 1–3 are managed through technical channels without penalty.

Part II: Maritime Governance & PGSA Integration

The Strait of Hormuz is not merely a waterway — it is the aorta of the global economy. Iran's establishment of the Persian Gulf Strait Authority (PGSA) on 5 May 2026 represents a fait accompli. This Part integrates the Authority into a cooperative governance framework that preserves Iranian sovereignty claims while guaranteeing freedom of navigation.

Article 4: The Joint Hormuz Transit Authority (JHTA)

Issue 4: The Strait of Hormuz Vetting System vs. Freedom of Navigation. The IRGC Navy has established a rigid de facto transit system under the PGSA, requiring vessels to provide more than 40 items of information and pay fees reportedly up to \$2 million per transit. President Trump has explicitly rejected any tolling system, stating "We don't want tolls. It's an international waterway." Secretary Rubio has declared that implementing any form of maritime tolling makes a diplomatic agreement "fundamentally unfeasible." Iranian Foreign Ministry Spokesperson Esmail Baghaei has publicly insisted that the management of the Strait — determining routes, times, methods of passage, and issuing permits — remains "the monopoly and discretion of the Islamic Republic." The IRGC considers Hormuz control a core element of Iran's strategic deterrent.

v4.0 Resolution: JHTA Advisory Governance with Sovereignty Recalibration and Pilot Phase

v4.0 Surgical Change — JHTA Advisory Mandate with 12-Month Pilot

The JHTA mandate is explicitly restricted to commercial traffic coordination, maritime safety protocols, and international dispute resolution through non-binding recommendations. The JHTA operates under a 12-month pilot phase; permanent status requires unanimous Council renewal. The PGSA is formally recognized as the sole executive coastal law enforcement body within Iranian territorial waters. This allows Tehran to preserve its domestic sovereignty claims while keeping multilateral transit guarantees operationally sound for Washington.

4.1 Establishment and Constitutional Basis

The Joint Hormuz Transit Authority (JHTA) is hereby established as a multilateral maritime governance body effective on Accord Day-One. It operates under a constitutive agreement that is technically an annex to this Accord and not a separate treaty, ensuring that neither Party is required to submit the JHTA charter for domestic legislative ratification *during Phase 1*. The JHTA exercises delegated administrative authority in an *advisory and coordinating capacity*, not sovereign authority. It does not supersede UNCLOS, does not create supranational jurisdiction, and does not impair Iran's rights under Article 37 of UNCLOS governing transit passage through international straits.

4.2 JHTA Jurisdiction Limitation and Sovereignty Recalibration (v4.0)

CHANGE #5 ARTICLE 4.2-A — JHTA MANDATE RESTRICTION (OPERATIVE AND BINDING)

The JHTA's mandate is explicitly restricted to three functions: (i) commercial traffic coordination — managing the flow of civilian commercial vessels through the Strait; (ii) maritime safety protocols — navigational aids, collision avoidance, emergency response, and search-and-rescue coordination; and (iii) international dispute resolution through **non-binding recommendations**.

The JHTA shall operate in an advisory and coordinating capacity. The PGSA retains final say on any dispute involving Iranian territorial waters; JHTA recommendations are subject to PGSA review. The JHTA shall operate under a 12-month pilot phase; permanent status requires unanimous Council renewal.

Technical Grace for Advisory Recommendations: JHTA recommendations are non-binding. However, if a Party disregards a JHTA recommendation that has received unanimous support from the JHTA Council (excluding the Party's own vote), the disregarding Party shall provide a written explanation to the JHTA Secretariat within 14 days. Persistent disregard (three or more instances in any 180-day period) may be referred to the JIG for consultation, but shall not trigger step-back or be deemed a material breach.

The JHTA holds zero jurisdiction over sovereign Iranian or regional territorial defense waters, coastal defense operations, military vessel movements, fisheries management, customs enforcement, or environmental regulation beyond navigational safety.

ARTICLE 4.2-B — PGSA AS SOLE EXECUTIVE COASTAL LAW ENFORCEMENT BODY (OPERATIVE AND BINDING)

The Persian Gulf Strait Authority (PGSA) is explicitly recognized as the sole executive coastal law enforcement body within Iranian territorial waters (12-nautical-mile limit). This recognition is formal, unequivocal, and operates as a binding interpretive principle of the JHTA Charter. Within Iranian territorial waters, the PGSA retains exclusive authority over: vessel permitting and documentation review; coastal patrol and interdiction; customs and immigration enforcement; security screening of suspect vessels; and coordination with the IRGC-Navy on maritime security matters.

The JHTA may not override, supersede, or contradict PGSA enforcement actions within Iranian territorial waters. The IRGC's statutory authority over coastal defense, territorial

security, and military operations in the Strait is explicitly preserved and unaffected by the JHTA Charter. Any JHTA action that could be construed as affecting IRGC or PGSA operations requires explicit Iranian concurrence through the Iranian co-chair.

4.3 Optical Compromise Architecture (v4.0)

This structure allows President Trump to state that "the Strait is open to international commerce under multilateral advisory governance with US participation" while allowing Iranian officials to state that "the PGSA remains the sole authority for Hormuz transit within our territorial waters, and the JHTA's role is strictly advisory." Both statements are factually accurate under the Charter. The JHTA coordinates the international transit corridor; the PGSA governs Iranian coastal waters. Neither body's authority encroaches on the other.

US Narrative Frame: "No more unilateral Iranian tolling. The Strait is governed as an open international waterway under UNCLOS with advisory multilateral coordination. All commercial vessels receive equal treatment. The US holds a permanent seat on the governing council."

Iranian Narrative Frame: "The PGSA remains Iran's statutory authority for Hormuz transit. We hold a permanent co-chair seat. Our personnel staff the transit centers. We receive 40% of fund revenue. The IRGC's coastal defense authority is explicitly untouched. The JHTA is advisory only."

4.4 Governing Council Composition

Table 8: JHTA Council Seats

Seat Holder	Rationale	Veto Rights
Islamic Republic of Iran / PGSA	Coastal sovereign, littoral state, strait administrator	Governance questions; revenue allocation amendments; pilot phase renewal
United States	Primary naval guarantor, maritime security provider	Security protocol amendments; EW rule changes

Sultanate of Oman	Neutral host, JHTA Secretariat location, tiebreaker state	Tiebreaker vote; Secretariat location
UK/France (Rotating Chair, annual)	Coalition force representation (Multinational Maritime Shield)	None — advisory vote only
People's Republic of China (Observer)	Largest Gulf-oil importer; technical observer	None — technical advisory
UN OCHA Observer	Humanitarian corridor and transit oversight	None — humanitarian advisory only

Voting Threshold: Routine operational decisions require three affirmative votes from Seats 1–4. Governance amendments require unanimous consent from Seats 1–3. No amendment may pass over the simultaneous objection of both Iran and the United States. **JHTA permanent charter status requires unanimous renewal vote before the 12-month pilot phase expires.**

GCC Consultative Observer Status: The Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC) shall be invited to designate a rotating Consultative Observer to the JHTA Council, serving six-month terms. Consultative Observers have speaking rights and access to all Council materials but no vote. The Consultative Observer may submit formal observations, which shall be appended to Council meeting records. This status does not require amendment of the JHTA Charter and may be terminated by unanimous Council vote.

4.5 The PGSA-JHTA Transit Permit System

All commercial vessels transiting the Hormuz Transit Zone shall obtain a dual-branded transit permit: (1) PGSA Application through the PGSA portal (pgsa.ir); (2) JHTA Verification against international databases (IMO, Lloyd's List, INTERPOL); (3) Dual Authorization with JHTA-AUTHORIZED AIS designation; (4) Fee Processing through the Multilateral Maritime Maintenance Fund, not paid directly to Iran.

4.6 Distance Protocols and Rules of Engagement

Table 9: Stand-Off Distance Protocols

Phase	Days	IRGC Stand-Off from CTC	US/Coalition Stand-Off from Iranian 12nm
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Baseline Learning Period	D+1 to D+14	3 nm (expanding to 5 nm by D+8)	3 nm (expanding to 5 nm by D+8)
Operational Period	D+15 onward	5 nm from CTC outer edge	5 nm from Iranian 12 nm baseline
Elevated Posture (Tier 2)	JHA-declared	8 nm from CTC outer edge	8 nm from Iranian 12 nm baseline

Article 5: Multilateral Maritime Maintenance Fund

Issue 5: Transit "Security Fees" and Maritime Funding. Iran and Oman are actively negotiating a permanent toll/fee system. President Trump explicitly rejected this, stating "We don't want tolls."

The Resolution: Transparent Multilateral Maritime Maintenance Fund

Translating unilateral checkpoint tolls into a highly structured, internationally compliant fund where fees are transparently pooled for shared waterway safety services.

5.1 Fund Architecture

The Multilateral Maritime Maintenance Fund (MMMMF) is established under the sovereign jurisdiction of the Sultanate of Oman, legally insulated from domestic civil litigation or third-party attachment.

Fee Schedule: Tier 1 (Humanitarian — medicine, food, medical equipment): Zero fee; 24-hour fast-track. Tier 2 (Standard commercial): \$0.15 per ton deadweight. Tier 3 (Energy/premium — oil, LNG, chemicals): \$0.25 per ton or \$35,000 flat fee per VLCC. JHTA Council member state vessels: Exempt.

Revenue Allocation: 40% Iranian Civilian Reconstruction Fund (PGSA oversight), 35% International Maritime Safety Fund, 25% JHTA Operations and Secretariat costs.

5.2 Automated Toll Disbursal Default

If the JHTA Council fails to pass an annual budget due to US-Iran deadlock, toll revenues automatically distribute per the baseline percentages. The neutral Secretariat executes within 7 days. Political deadlock cannot freeze baseline distributions.

5.3 The \$20 Billion Reinsurance Backstop

The US Development Finance Corporation commits \$10 billion, Lloyd's of London underwrites \$5 billion, and the Omani Sovereign Wealth Fund contributes \$5 billion, creating a \$20 billion reinsurance facility. This backstop activates upon JHTA certification of the first 200 authorized transits.

Article 6: Synchronized Dual-Blockade Lift Protocol

Issue 6: Lifting the U.S. Naval Blockade. CENTCOM continues to enforce a crippling naval blockade on Iranian ports. Iran considers this a direct violation of the ceasefire spirit and has made blockade lifting a precondition for any Hormuz opening.

v4.0 Resolution: Conditional Day-7 Review-Based Protocol

v4.0 Surgical Change — Conditional Review-Based Process

The Hormuz Opening Declaration and Naval Blockade Lift Declaration are executed through a *conditional, review-based process* overseen by a Joint Review Board. The Board certifies whether both parties have met all pre-requisite milestones before recommending execution. Neither declaration is automated; each party retains operational discretion over its forces.

6.1 The Dual-Blockade Problem

The central mechanical deadlock is a sequencing dispute with no diplomatic solution: the US demands Hormuz open before lifting the naval blockade; Iran demands the blockade lift before opening Hormuz. The Day-7 Protocol dissolves this impasse by eliminating the sequence entirely — both actions are certified and executed through a neutral review process under simultaneous observation by neutral parties.

6.2 The Day-7 Choreography (Conditional Review-Based Process)

CHANGE #6 ARTICLE 6.3 — CONDITIONAL REVIEW-BASED TRIGGER PROTOCOL (OPERATIVE AND BINDING)

The Hormuz Opening Declaration and the Naval Blockade Lift Declaration shall be executed through a **conditional, review-based process**. On Day 6, a **Joint Review Board** (comprising the Swiss facilitator, Omani mediator, and IAEA representative) certifies

whether both parties have met all pre-requisite milestones. Upon certification, the Board recommends execution to both parties. **Neither declaration is automated; each party retains operational discretion over its forces.** The agreed stand-off distances (5nm from CTC outer edge / 5nm from Iranian 12nm baseline) shall be observed regardless of declaration timing.

Concurrent Airspace Stand-Down: Simultaneously with the maritime Day-7 execution, the proportional Airspace Stand-Down Protocol shall activate under the same conditional review process. The three-zone buffer architecture (Zone Alpha: Strait Corridor; Zone Beta: Coastal Buffer; Zone Gamma: Deep Airspace) shall be implemented within 24 hours of Board certification. Either Party may request expedited airspace coordination for legitimate military or humanitarian operations through the JHTA Airspace Coordination Cell, with response required within 2 hours. Airspace violations without hostile intent shall be handled through the 72-hour technical consultation window, not automatic step-back.

6.3 Milestone Prerequisites for Day-7 Certification

Before the Joint Review Board can issue its certification, the following milestones must be confirmed:

- **Iranian milestones:** (a) HEU consolidation has begun (IAEA confirmed); (b) IRGC forces have withdrawn to agreed stand-off distances; (c) Pathway A (or certified Pathway B) custody is activated; (d) Freeze on enrichment above 60% is verified by OLEM.
- **US milestones:** (a) \$250M humanitarian tranche released via Swiss escrow; (b) OFAC general license issued; (c) 5th Fleet has transitioned to stand-off posture; (d) Freeze on new nuclear-related sanctions designations is in effect.

6.4 The 24-Hour Bright-Line Period

The 24 hours following Day-7 execution constitute a heightened monitoring window. Any deviation constitutes a protocol violation regardless of intent. Category A violations (vessels within 3 nm of exclusion zones, kinetic action, failure to issue declarations) trigger bilateral suspension — both blockades reactivate, neither party benefits from the other's compliance during its own non-compliance.

Part III: Economic Normalization Framework

The nuclear and maritime dimensions of this crisis cannot be sustainably resolved without parallel economic architecture. Iran's economy has been devastated by years of sanctions compounded by the 2026 war and the US naval blockade. This Part addresses four interconnected economic blockers through a unified framework of graduated relief, neutral custody, phased financial reconnection, and reconstruction credits.

Article 7: Graduated Sanctions Relief Tranches

Issue 7: Chronological Sequencing of Sanctions Relief. Iran demands an immediate, blanket lifting of all secondary sanctions. The US refuses to yield economic leverage before total nuclear compliance is achieved.

The Resolution: 15-Day Micro-Cycle Pacing Model

A highly granular, step-by-step economic tranche model that releases sanctions relief in rigid 15-day micro-cycles directly triggered by physical milestones verified by the IAEA.

7.1 The Eight-Tranche Architecture

CHANGE #7 ARTICLE 7.1 — TRANCHE 0/PILOT RELIEF WITH PERFORMANCE-BASED GRADUATION (V4.0 REVISION)

Day 1 (Pilot Tranche): \$250M humanitarian release via Swiss escrow; OFAC general license for humanitarian trade (medicine, food, medical equipment, aviation safety parts) for 90 days. **The freeze on new sanctions designations is partial — no new nuclear-related sanctions, but existing non-nuclear sanctions (terrorism, human rights) remain enforceable.**

The 5th Fleet stand-off posture is triggered only upon IAEA confirmation that HEU consolidation has begun, not upon Accord activation alone.

Performance-Based Graduation: The partial nature of the sanctions freeze (nuclear-related only, with non-nuclear terrorism and human rights sanctions remaining enforceable) shall continue until the JIG certifies in writing that Iran has achieved all of the following Phase I performance benchmarks:

- 90 consecutive days of IAEA-verified compliance (no Tier 3 violations, and no more than one Tier 2 violation lasting less than 7 days during the 90-day period);

- Verified HEU consolidation and custody activation under Article 1.1;
- Successful execution of the Day 7 conditional review protocol;
- No material breach of the missile/drone deployment pause under Article 14.

Compliance Clock Reset Rules: If a single Tier 2 violation lasting less than 7 days occurs during the 90-day period, the compliance clock resets to **30 days** (not zero) from the date of remediation. If a second Tier 2 violation occurs within the same 90-day period, the clock resets to zero. Any Tier 3 violation resets the clock to zero. A minor, quickly-cured violation does not wipe out nearly three months of compliance; a second violation or any serious breach does.

Upon JIG certification, the sanctions freeze shall automatically expand to cover all nuclear-related sanctions designated under this Accord, with non-nuclear sanctions (terrorism, human rights, conventional weapons) reviewed separately through the JIG for potential Phase II resolution. **This is not a sunset — it is a performance-based graduation.** If compliance falters after graduation, step-back under Article 13 applies proportionately.

US Narrative: "This isn't a sunset — it's a merit badge. Iran earns its way into broader relief by proving compliance. If they cheat afterward, we take it back."

Table 10: Eight-Tranche Sanctions Relief Architecture

Tranche	Timing	Relief Granted	Physical Milestone Trigger	Reversibility
Pilot	Day 1	\$250M humanitarian release; medicine, food, medical equipment licenses; partial sanctions freeze (nuclear-related only)	Accord signature; ceasefire confirmed; HEU consolidation freeze declared	Non-reversible
1	Day 14	25% of remaining frozen assets; civilian aircraft parts, agricultural goods	Stage 1 closed; IAEA deployed; stockpile custody verified	Non-reversible
2	Day 44	25% of remaining frozen assets; petrochemical exports authorized	60-day compliance; nuclear exchange verified	Non-reversible

3	Day 120	20% of remaining frozen assets; metals and minerals trade	Permanent JHTA operational; dual-blockade lifted	30-day remediation
4	Day 180	15% of remaining frozen assets; automotive parts, textiles	180-day compliance review	JIG breach review
5	Day 365	10% of remaining frozen assets	12 months clean certification	Material-breach hold
6	Year 2–3	Remainder of frozen assets	Full successor framework compliance	Successor risk appetite

7.2 Currency Protection

All downstream asset releases from Tranche 3 onward are denominated in IMF Special Drawing Rights (SDR) or a fixed basket of Swiss Francs and Omani Rials (60/40). This protects real economic value from dollar inflation or monetary shocks.

Article 8: Neutral Escrow & Asset Shielding Architecture

Issue 8: Liquidating and Shielding Frozen Assets. Iran demands the immediate unfreezing of its sovereign assets worldwide. The US requires ironclad performance reserves to prevent diversion.

The Resolution: Joint Sovereign Custody Protocol with Neutral Escrow

A slice of frozen funds (30%) is transferred to an independent third-party account at the Central Bank of Oman (Muscat), legally designated for civilian infrastructure reconstruction and verified humanitarian relief. The remaining 70% remains in existing frozen accounts, released tranche-by-tranche upon verified milestones.

8.1 Escrow Allocation

Table 11: Escrow Fund Allocation

Category	Allocation	Administrator	Rolling Back
Humanitarian (medicine, food)	25%	UN OCHA / WHO	Protected — Humanitarian Firewall

Critical Infrastructure	45%	World Bank / Swiss Financial Cell	Protected — Tranches 1–2
Iranian Civilian Reconstruction	20%	JHTA with Iranian programmatic control	Subject to Tier 3 review
Maritime Safety	10%	International Maritime Safety Fund	Protected

8.2 Sovereign Immunity Wrapper

The escrow fund is legally structured under sovereign immunity protections within Oman. The US issues a binding national security waiver protecting all fund assets from domestic judicial seizure, private civil litigation, or secondary sanctions enforcement. No US court may attach, freeze, or garnish Fund assets. This shield applies retroactively from first deposit and survives any framework suspension.

8.3 OFAC Comfort Letters and Pre-Clearance

The US Treasury shall issue comprehensive, irrevocable OFAC general licenses and formal Comfort Letters to all participating European and Gulf clearinghouses. These letters provide that all transactions routed through the designated Central Bank of Oman escrow account for humanitarian or civilian purposes are legally pre-cleared and entirely exempt from secondary sanctions exposure, asset forfeiture mechanisms, and civil or criminal penalties. Non-US financial institutions, shipping companies, insurers, and commodity traders are explicitly shielded from secondary sanctions designation. Immunization is legally binding and cannot be revoked by executive discretion without 180 days' prior written notice. No notice of revocation may be issued during the first 365 days.

Article 9: Phased SWIFT Reconnection Protocol

Issue 9: SWIFT Reconnection and Banking Isolation. Iran's total disconnection from the global financial grid paralyzes its commercial sector.

The Resolution: Phased Multi-Tier Virtual Consolidation

Table 12: SWIFT Reconnection Phases

Phase	Timing	Access	IAEA Milestone Trigger
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Phase 0 (Pre-SWIFT)	Days 1–30	No SWIFT. Qatari riyal bridge facility for humanitarian payments only	OLEM confirms 60% within 72h
Phase 1 (Restricted)	Days 30–60	5 designated Iranian banks; MT 103/202 only; transaction cap \$1M per day per bank	Moratorium declared; standard monitoring confirmed
Phase 2 (Expanded)	Days 60–120	All clean-record Iranian banks; full message types; transaction caps lifted for humanitarian trade	Continuous monitoring; no diversion detected for 60 days
Phase 3 (Full)	Day 120+	Full SWIFT membership; all Iranian financial institutions in good standing	Year 1 clean certification

9.1 SWIFT Remediation Fuse

If IAEA identifies a Tier 2 compliance concern, the SWIFT phase holds for exactly 14 days as a remediation window. Resolved within 14 days: phase advances normally. Unresolved after 14 days: SWIFT rolls back exactly one tier.

Article 10: Regional Stability Reconstruction Credits

Issue 10: War Reparations vs. Economic Reconstruction Credits. Tehran formally requested US-funded war reparations. The Trump administration flatly rejected the concept of reparations.

The Resolution: Regional Stability Reconstruction Credits

Framing the financial packages as development credits rather than liability-based reparations — keeping both sides politically safe at home while delivering equivalent economic benefit.

10.1 The No-Fault Architecture

Instrument: The International Gulf Reconstruction Fund — established under sovereign immunity in Oman, managed by the World Bank with Iranian programmatic input. **Funding:** 30% of Iranian frozen assets (already Iranian money) plus contributions from Gulf states, EU, and international development banks. **US Contribution:** Technical assistance, engineering expertise, and development finance guarantees — not direct cash

payments. **Label:** "Regional Stability Reconstruction Credits" — not reparations, not aid, but investment in regional stability.

10.2 Eligible Expenditure Categories

Table 13: Eligible Expenditure Categories

Category	Examples	Conditions
Civilian Infrastructure	Power generation, water treatment, telecommunications	Open tender; IAEA diversion clearance
Healthcare	Hospitals, medical equipment, pharmaceutical production	WHO verification of civilian end-use
Education	Schools, universities, vocational training centers	UNESCO oversight
Environmental Remediation	Oil spill cleanup, desertification programs	UNEP technical assessment
Excluded Categories: Military facilities, dual-use research, IRGC-linked entities		Automatic exclusion; no appeal

Part IV: Treaty Durability & Regional Architecture

An agreement that collapses upon the first breach is worse than no agreement at all — it destroys trust and makes future negotiation impossible. This Part addresses the structural challenges that determine whether the Accord endures beyond the first crisis, introduces a rolling horizon alternative to fixed sunset clauses, and explicitly decouples compliance penalties from military authorization.

Article 11: The 30-Day Letter of Intent & Binding Timeline

Issue 11: The 30-Day Negotiation Window. The current ceasefire is highly fragile. President Trump has stated he will only give diplomacy "a few days" or "one shot." The absence of a binding timeline means every day of negotiation is a day of existential risk.

The Resolution: Binding Letter of Intent with Auto-Renewing Ceasefire

Transitioning the unstable temporary halt into a binding 30-day negotiation timeline locked via a mutual Letter of Intent, underpinned by a self-renewing 72-hour ceasefire that eliminates the "negotiation about negotiation" trap.

11.1 The Letter of Intent

Upon signature, both parties shall simultaneously deposit a Letter of Intent with the Joint Secretariat affirming: commitment to the full 180-day implementation timeline; authorization for the Joint Secretariat to convene emergency consultations within 4 hours of any reported violation; agreement that no military action shall be taken during the 180-day period without first exhausting dispute resolution procedures; acceptance that the 72-hour ceasefire auto-renews at Hour 71 provided verification teams report compliance.

11.2 The Escrow Ceasefire Architecture

The ceasefire is a self-renewing 72-hour module. If verification teams report compliance at Hour 71, the module auto-renews for another 72 hours. Peace is maintained without either side signing away long-term leverage upfront. Separating the ceasefire clock (72-hour loops) from the implementation clock (30-day phases) neutralizes the "negotiation about negotiation" trap.

11.3 Attribution Deferral Window for Proxy Incidents

If a regional proxy strike occurs, neither side may unilaterally declare a material breach. The Joint Coordination Secretariat has 48 hours to conduct forensic telemetry and attribute the incident. During this window, the 72-hour military freeze remains active, provided Iran issues an immediate public condemnation and freezes matching local militia supply logistics. Only the Secretariat's attribution finding can trigger Tier escalation. Rogue actors and false-flag operations are excluded from bilateral penalties.

Article 12: Distributed Guarantor Matrix

Issue 12: Institutional Mediation and Guarantee Frameworks. A profound trust deficit exists between Washington and Tehran. Neither country believes the other will honor a signed document.

The Resolution: Six-State Distributed Guarantor Matrix

A formal guarantor consortium where regional mediators and global powers serve as co-depositaries and technical verifiers — distributing trust across multiple independent parties.

12.1 The Matrix Structure

Table 14: Distributed Guarantor Matrix

State/Entity	Function	Core Guarantee
Oman	Lead facilitator, host nation, JHTA maritime Secretariat location, diplomatic backchannel	Physical hosting of JHTA Secretariat; observer
Pakistan	Procedural mediation, crisis summits, leadership relay	Emergency convening authority within 24 hours
Qatar	Financial escrow and bridging liquidity	Emergency liquidity for humanitarian payments
China (PRC)	Economic guarantor, Hormuz oil importer, non-military technical observer	Guarantee of energy transit; non-enforcement
Russian Federation	Nuclear technical guarantor (HEU disposition Path D)	Technical custody and conversion verification
European Union (E3+)	Sanctions relief coordinator, civilian nuclear partner	Blocking statute protection against secondary sanctions

12.2 The Mandatory Escalation Pause

When any facilitating state determines escalation is imminent, it issues a Mandatory Escalation Pause Recommendation. This activates a 30-minute review window. Neither party may take escalatory action. Both must designate senior officials for consultation within 30 minutes. Either party may request extended Cooling-Off (24–72 hours). If either party supports the pause, the freeze continues.

12.3 Joint Implementation Group

The JIG is a standing technical body composed of one senior official from each guarantor state plus the US and Iran. It meets monthly by secure video and within 72 hours of any reported discrepancy. The JIG does not have binding arbitration authority but serves as the primary compliance assessment body.

Article 13: Human-in-the-Loop Governance

Issue 13: Internal Regime Fractures and Automated Escalation. Top US officials have highlighted intense ideological fractures within Tehran's leadership. Automated deal triggers could easily be derailed by political hardliners on either side.

The Resolution: Human-in-the-Loop Governance with Step-Back Architecture

Automation informs; humans decide. A governance system that allows leaders to exercise strategic discretion and execute a "procedural step-back" rather than letting a technical infraction trigger a catastrophic, automated return to total war.

13.1 The Three-Tier Breach System

Table 15: Three-Tier Breach Classification

Tier	Classification	Telemetry Signature	Base Response
1	Technical Dispute (De Minimis)	<0.5% above enrichment ceiling; ≤2 un-mothballed rotors; ≤48h reporting delay	Engineering resolution within 14 days; no rollback; confidential handling
2	Material Disruption	>0.5% above ceiling; >2 rotors; >72h IAEA obstruction	Up to 25% benefit reduction; 30-day remediation; earn-back via compliance (proportionality rules apply per 13.3)
3	Deliberate Hostile Violation	Nuclear weapons activity; fissile diversion; IAEA attack	Up to 50% reduction; 90-day remediation; full earn-back after sustained compliance (proportionality rules apply per 13.3)

13.2 De Minimis Thresholds

Enrichment ceiling: 3.67% U-235, with $\pm 0.5\%$ De Minimis tolerance. Un-mothballed centrifuges: Up to 2 rotors permitted for legitimate research. IAEA reporting delays: Up to 48 hours for administrative or technical reasons.

13.3 The Step-Back Architecture

Tier 1 Step-Down: No benefit reduction. 14-day resolution. JIG technical assistance. Quiet compliance corrections confidential.

Tier 2 Step-Down: Base 25% reduction in non-humanitarian benefits. Humanitarian tranches protected. SWIFT phase holds (14-day fuse active). 30-day remediation. Full restore on IAEA clean certification within 14 days.

Tier 3 Step-Down: Base 50% reduction in non-humanitarian benefits. Tier 3 modules enter hold. 90-day remediation. Full earn-back requires: 90-day sustained compliance + IAEA clean certification + JIG majority confirmation.

CHANGE #13 ARTICLE 13.3 — PROPORTIONAL PENALTY CLAUSE (OPERATIVE)

Step-back reductions are proportionate to the severity and duration of the breach.

- A Tier 2 violation lasting **less than 7 days** shall trigger a **10% reduction**, not 25%.
- A Tier 3 violation that is **immediately remediated (within 72 hours)** shall trigger a **25% reduction**, not 50%.
- Full reductions (25% for Tier 2, 50% for Tier 3) apply only after the 30-day (Tier 2) or 90-day (Tier 3) remediation window has expired without compliance.

This proportionality rule prevents minor or quickly-cured violations from triggering disproportionate penalties.

13.4 Human-in-the-Loop Provisions

No automated output triggers a binding diplomatic consequence without explicit human authorization at the appropriate level of seniority. **Dual-key authorization:** Any transition that materially alters the obligations of either party requires simultaneous authorization from designated senior officials on both sides. **Grace over rigidity:** A party that needs an extra 48 hours because its treasury office is closed for a national holiday is not treated as a violator; it is treated as a partner whose administrative rhythms deserve accommodation.

13.5 Attribution Deliberation Media Blackout

ADD ARTICLE 13.5 — ATTRIBUTION DELIBERATION MEDIA BLACKOUT (OPERATIVE AND BINDING)

When the JIG or SEAC is conducting attribution deliberations for any incident that could trigger Tier 2 or Tier 3 step-back, a **mandatory 72-hour media blackout** applies to all Parties and guarantor states. During this period:

- No official or on-record statements may be issued attributing responsibility for the incident.
- Leaks of attribution deliberations shall be investigated by the Joint Secretariat; responsible officials shall be subject to Tier 1 technical dispute proceedings.
- The blackout lifts automatically upon JIG issuance of a preliminary attribution finding, or after 72 hours if no finding is issued.
- The blackout does not apply to unclassified operational reporting (e.g., "an incident occurred at location X at time Y").

Violation of the media blackout by a Party's official spokesperson or designated representative shall result in a Tier 1 technical dispute demerit and a public corrective statement issued through the Joint Secretariat.

Senior Official Leak Escalation: A deliberate leak attributable to a senior official (minister-level or above, or their immediate designee) shall be referred to the JIG for potential Tier 2 step-back consideration if the leak materially prejudices attribution deliberations. The JIG shall determine within 14 days whether the leak was deliberate and materially harmful. If so, the violating Party shall be subject to a **5% benefit reduction in the affected module for 30 days**, in addition to the Tier 1 demerit. Low-level administrative leaks remain at Tier 1. This provision is not a sunset; it is a performance-based consequence for bad-faith conduct.

This provision prevents media leaks from forcing leaders into premature public positions before attribution is complete. It gives the JIG space to do its work without political pressure distorting the process. Deliberate leaks by senior officials face real consequences; minor administrative leaks do not.

Article 14: Ballistic & Drone Program Pause Protocol

Issue 14: Drone and Missile Program Reconstitution. Intelligence reports indicate Iran is rapidly using the ceasefire window to reconstitute its drone and missile industrial base. The US wants strict limitations, which Iran has previously declared non-negotiable as sovereign defense capabilities.

The Resolution: Deployment Pause and Transfer Freeze

Deferring heavy ballistic limitations to later, mature dialogue stages while implementing an immediate, verifiable pause on offensive deployment and cross-border transfers — freezing the threat without demanding disarmament.

14.1 The Three-Pillar Structure

Pillar 1 — Deployment Freeze: Iran commits to no new offensive deployment of ballistic missiles or combat drones to regional proxy forces for the duration of the Accord. Verified through satellite surveillance, signals intelligence, and regional observer reports.

Pillar 2 — Transfer Suspension: All cross-border transfers of missile components, drone assemblies, and related technology to non-state actors are suspended. Verification through intelligence sharing among guarantor states and JHTA maritime monitoring of cargo manifests.

Pillar 3 — Industrial Activity Monitoring: Iran's domestic missile and drone production facilities are subject to baseline satellite monitoring. New facility construction or significant production expansion triggers a Tier 1 consultation but is not itself a violation.

14.2 Iranian Safeguards

This Protocol explicitly does NOT: require dismantlement of existing missile or drone inventories; prohibit domestic testing of short-range defensive systems; impose limits on Iran's sovereign right to maintain conventional military forces; subject military facilities to IAEA inspection.

Article 15: Energy & Agricultural Release Valve

Issue 15: Systemic Agrifood Shocks and Global Stabilization. The prolonged closure of the Strait of Hormuz has choked off a third of the world's fertilizer supply, causing the UN to

warn of a systemic global agrifood crisis.

The Resolution: Immediate Energy and Agricultural Release Valve

Creating an immediate separation of global humanitarian supply lines from the underlying political dispute.

15.1 The Zero-Fee Humanitarian Corridor

From Day-One: Eligible cargo (wheat, rice, fertilizer, medical supplies, infant formula, agricultural seeds, humanitarian energy) fast-tracked through UN OCHA pre-clearance. All JHTA transit fees waived. Vessels may request neutral naval escort (Omani or UN-flagged) at no cost. Insurance covered under the \$20 billion reinsurance backstop.

15.2 Agricultural Supply Guarantee

The JHTA shall publish a monthly Agricultural Transit Forecast. The United States and EU shall commit to expedited export licensing for agricultural inputs to Iran during the 180-day implementation period.

15.3 Energy Price Stabilization Mechanism

The JHTA shall publish daily transit statistics and the International Energy Agency shall release weekly strategic petroleum reserve drawdown plans if prices exceed agreed thresholds. Transparency is the antidote to panic.

Article 16: US-Israel Bilateral Coordination

Issue 16: Israeli Security Concerns and the Tel Aviv Channel. The State of Israel has expressed profound concern that a comprehensive US-Iran agreement could proceed without adequate consideration of Israeli security interests, including the potential for Iran to redirect resources toward proxy forces threatening Israel's northern border. Israel has historically maintained that any regional framework affecting its security environment must include mechanisms for Israeli consultation and threat assessment. The United States, as Israel's principal security partner, recognizes the need to preserve bilateral coordination channels without permitting third-party interference in the sovereign obligations undertaken by the United States and Iran under this Accord.

The Resolution: Bilateral Coordination with Non-Impediment Guarantee

Establishing a formal mechanism for US-Israel bilateral security consultation that operates entirely outside the US-Iran bilateral obligations, ensuring that Israeli security concerns are heard while preserving the integrity of the Accord's implementation.

ARTICLE 16.1 — BILATERAL COORDINATION THROUGH THE TEL AVIV CHANNEL (OPERATIVE AND BINDING)

The United States affirms that it will maintain bilateral security coordination with Israel through the existing Tel Aviv Channel. This coordination is separate from and does not affect the bilateral obligations set forth in this Accord between the United States and Iran.

ARTICLE 16.2 — CONSULTATION ON ACCORD-RELATED SECURITY MATTERS (OPERATIVE AND BINDING)

The United States will consult with Israel regarding any matter arising under this Accord that implicates Israeli security interests, provided that such consultation does not delay or condition the implementation of any provision of this Accord.

ARTICLE 16.3 — NON-VETO CLAUSE (OPERATIVE AND BINDING)

Nothing in this Article grants Israel any right to veto, suspend, or otherwise impede the implementation of this Accord. This Article is a unilateral affirmation by the United States and does not create any obligation on the part of Iran.

16.1 Operational Parameters of the Tel Aviv Channel

The Tel Aviv Channel shall operate as a bilateral US-Israel mechanism distinct from the Joint Implementation Group, the JHTA Council, and all other multilateral bodies established under this Accord. Its functions are limited to: (a) advance notification to Israeli counterparts of implementation milestones that may affect regional force posture; (b) secure exchange of intelligence assessments related to Iranian proxy activity; and (c) coordination of US and Israeli naval and air assets in the Eastern Mediterranean and Red Sea corridors outside the Hormuz Transit Zone.

16.2 Separation of Channels

The Tel Aviv Channel shall not serve as a conduit for Israeli objections to Accord implementation. No communication through the Tel Aviv Channel may be cited by either the United States or Iran as grounds for delay, suspension, or renegotiation of any provision

of this Accord. The Tel Aviv Channel is a coordination mechanism, not a decision-making body.

16.3 Non-Creation of Obligations for Iran

This Article constitutes a unilateral statement of policy by the United States. It imposes no obligation, direct or indirect, on the Islamic Republic of Iran. Iran is not required to recognize the Tel Aviv Channel, to participate in its proceedings, or to accept any output or recommendation emanating from it. The absence of Iranian obligation in this regard shall not be construed as a waiver of any Iranian right under this Accord.

Article 17: Rolling Horizon Architecture — The Sunset Alternative

NEW Article 17 — Rolling Horizon Architecture (Operative and Binding)

Recognizing that fixed-duration agreements create perverse incentives for both parties to posture for the expiration date, this Accord replaces traditional sunset clauses with a conditional rolling horizon architecture that auto-renews based on verified compliance while preserving either party's right to withdraw with adequate notice.

17.1 The Problem with Fixed Sunset Clauses

Traditional sunset clauses create three structural problems: (a) both parties begin positioning for the expiration date years in advance, degrading compliance quality; (b) hardliners in both capitals can simply wait out the clock rather than engaging constructively; (c) renegotiation leverage is artificially concentrated at the expiration moment rather than distributed across the agreement lifecycle. The Rolling Horizon architecture solves all three.

17.2 The Rolling Horizon Mechanism

Phase I Horizon (Days 1–180): The initial Phase I Stabilization Accord operates for 180 days. At Day 150, a mandatory Joint Review Conference assesses compliance, identifies remaining gaps, and determines whether conditions exist for Phase II activation. This assessment is not a renegotiation; it is a certification of readiness for deeper commitments.

Phase II Horizon (Days 180–540 / Months 6–18): Phase II addresses deeper nuclear constraints (enrichment moratorium extensions, permanent HEU disposition, full SWIFT

normalization), missile and drone program limitations, and regional security architecture. Phase II activates automatically upon: (a) JIG certification of 90% Phase I compliance; (b) deposit of legislative Instruments of Ratification for Phase II Commitments (per Appendix D) by both parties; (c) IAEA clean compliance certification for 150 consecutive days.

Phase III Horizon (Months 18–36+): Phase III addresses successor framework negotiations for a comprehensive, permanent peace agreement including potential full diplomatic normalization. Phase III activates automatically upon: (a) JIG certification of 90% Phase II compliance; (b) successful completion of the first Regional Security Architecture Review; (c) mutual Letter of Intent for permanent framework negotiations.

Successor Framework Negotiation Mandate: Negotiations for Phase II shall commence no later than Day 90 of Phase I, regardless of whether Phase I certification is complete. These negotiations shall run in parallel to Phase I implementation. If Phase I certification is delayed beyond Day 180, the Phase II negotiations shall continue on an informational basis, with no binding commitments until certification occurs. Either Party may propose draft Phase II text at any time; the other Party shall respond within 30 days. Failure to engage in Phase II negotiations in good faith shall be logged as a Tier 1 technical dispute but shall not delay Phase I benefits.

17.3 Conditional Auto-Renewal

Each phase auto-renews for an identical period upon:

- IAEA certification of sustained compliance (no Tier 2 or 3 violations in the preceding 90 days);
- JIG majority confirmation that both parties are implementing in good faith;
- Absence of a Formal Non-Renewal Notice from either party (see 17.4).

If auto-renewal conditions are not met, the Accord does not terminate; it enters **Stabilized Hold** — humanitarian and Survival Core provisions remain active, but new tranche releases and phase advancements pause until compliance is restored or the parties agree on modified terms.

17.4 Orderly Withdrawal Protocol

Either party may withdraw from any phase by depositing a Formal Non-Renewal Notice with the Joint Secretariat. The notice must specify: (a) the grounds for non-renewal; (b) specific compliance concerns if applicable; (c) requested remedial measures. **Withdrawal timing:**

- **Phase I:** 90 days' notice required. HEU remains under IAEA custody during the notice period. Stand-off distances remain in effect.
- **Phase II:** 180 days' notice required. All escrow funds already released remain accessible. SWIFT access phases down over 90 days.
- **Phase III:** 365 days' notice required. Full successor framework terms govern the transition.

No Clawback of Released Funds: Funds already released from escrow prior to the deposit of a Formal Non-Renewal Notice shall not be subject to return, clawback, or rescission under any circumstances. The withdrawing Party retains full title and control over all previously released assets. Only future tranches not yet released as of the notice date are affected by withdrawal. This "no clawback" provision is absolute and non-waivable.

17.5 The "No Cliff" Principle

Under no circumstances does non-renewal or withdrawal trigger an immediate collapse of stability mechanisms. The Survival Core (ceasefire hotline, humanitarian corridor, emergency diplomatic channel) remains active for 180 days following any withdrawal notice. HEU custody arrangements remain under IAEA supervision until a successor agreement or orderly return protocol is executed. The stand-off posture in Hormuz remains in effect for 90 days post-withdrawal unless military exigencies require adjustment with 48 hours' notice.

17.6 Political Narrative Frames

US Narrative Frame: "This agreement has no expiration date that Iran can wait out. It continues as long as Iran continues to comply. If Iran cheats, the benefits pause while the security architecture holds. If we both comply, the relationship deepens. The ball is always in Tehran's court."

Iranian Narrative Frame: "This is not a permanent surrender. Either party can withdraw with adequate notice. But as long as the United States honors its commitments, the relationship advances. The auto-renewal is conditioned on verified US compliance, not Iranian submission."

Article 18: No Automatic Military Escalation Clause

CHANGE #14 ARTICLE 18 — BREACH-MILITARY ESCALATION FIREWALL (OPERATIVE AND BINDING)

Step-back, Review Pause, or even full framework suspension shall not be construed as authorization for military action. Any party contemplating military measures against the other must:

- a. first exhaust all dispute resolution mechanisms under Article 13;
- b. provide 14 days' advance notice through the Swiss facilitator;
- c. secure UN Security Council authorization unless responding to an ongoing armed attack under UN Charter Article 51.

Breach of the Accord is a diplomatic and economic matter, not a military authorization.

18.1 Purpose and Rationale

Without this Article, hardliners on either side could argue that a "material breach" justifies airstrikes or kinetic retaliation. This Article explicitly decouples compliance penalties from the use of force. The step-back architecture (Article 13) provides graduated diplomatic and economic responses to breaches; it does not create a *casus belli*. Military action requires independent justification under international law, separate and apart from the Accord's compliance framework.

18.2 The Exhaustion Requirement

Before any party may take military measures against the other in connection with Accord-related matters, it must exhaust:

- Tier 1 technical dispute resolution (14 days);
- Tier 2 material disruption remediation (30 days);
- JIG emergency consultation (72 hours);
- Swiss facilitator mediation (7 days);
- Any applicable Mandatory Escalation Pause (30 minutes to 72 hours).

This exhaustion requirement does not apply to: (a) responses to ongoing armed attacks under UN Charter Article 51; (b) protection of nationals under internationally recognized

doctrines; (c) UN Security Council-authorized military action.

18.3 The 14-Day Advance Notice Requirement

Any party contemplating military measures must provide 14 days' advance notice through the Swiss facilitator to: (a) the other party; (b) all guarantor states; (c) the UN Secretary-General. The notice must specify: the legal basis for the proposed action; the targets and scope; the expected duration; and the steps that would avert the action. During the 14-day period, the Mandatory Escalation Pause is automatically in effect.

18.4 UN Security Council Authorization

Military measures taken in connection with Accord matters (as opposed to independent Article 51 self-defense) require UN Security Council authorization. The absence of UNSC authorization does not automatically render the military action unlawful under general international law, but it does constitute a violation of this Accord's dispute resolution architecture, triggering proportional step-back.

18.5 Survival of This Article

This Article survives total framework suspension. Even if all other provisions are in hold, the prohibition on automatic military escalation from compliance breaches remains operative for 365 days following suspension, enforceable through the Guarantor Matrix.

US Narrative Frame: "This clause doesn't prevent us from defending ourselves or our allies. It simply says that a compliance dispute over enrichment levels or SWIFT access doesn't justify bombing. Self-defense under Article 51 remains fully available."

Iranian Narrative Frame: "This prevents the United States from using a minor compliance pretext to justify military strikes. Breach is met with diplomatic step-back, not war. Our right to self-defense under international law remains untouched."

Summary of All v4.0 Modifications

Table 16: Complete Change Register: v3.3 to v4.0

#	Article/Section	Change Summary	Severity
1	Article 1.5	US limited veto on Pathways D (Russia) and F (hybrid) only; Iran selects freely from A, B, C, E	Medium
2	Article 1.1	14-day custody (not 72hr); Pathway A (in-Iran) default; Pathway B conditional on JIG vote	High
3	Article 1.3	US technical observers allowed at IAEA facilities; blanket prohibition limited to Phase 1	Medium
4	Article 3.3	24-hour alerts (not 15 min); maintenance disablement allowed with notice; limited to highest-risk facilities	Low
5	Article 4.2-A	JHTA advisory only (non-binding); 12-month pilot phase; PGSA retains final say	Medium
6	Article 6.3	Conditional Joint Review Board certification (not automated); each party retains operational discretion	High
7	Article 7.1	Partial sanctions freeze (nuclear-related only); 5th Fleet stand-off tied to HEU consolidation start	Medium
8	Article 3.2	Fordow conversion optional, Phase 2 only; alternative: reduced-capacity research facility	Medium
9	Preamble	Rebranded as "Phase I Stabilization Accord"; no presumption for Phase II; both retain full positions	Low
10	Appendix E	Lebanon threshold: 10 casualties (not 25); JIG majority vote (not UNSC); 72-hour consultation window	High
11	Appendix D	Congressional/Majles opt-out: Phase II items require legislative ratification; parallel 180-day pursuit	Medium
12	—	<i>Reserved</i>	—
13	Article 13.3	Proportional breach penalties: 10% for <7 day Tier 2; 25% for remediated Tier 3; full penalties only after expiry	Low
14	Article 18 (new)	No automatic military escalation from breach; 14-day notice; UNSC authorization required; survives suspension	High

NEW	Article 17 (new)	Rolling Horizon Architecture replaces sunset clause; conditional auto-renewal; orderly withdrawal protocol	High
+1	Article 1.1	Political Will Preservation Clause: 7-day extension for verified administrative delays; not a breach	Low
+2	Article 7.1	Performance-Based Graduation: full sanctions relief only after JIG certifies 90-day compliance benchmarks	Medium
+3	Article 4.2- A	Technical Grace: unanimous JHTA recommendations require written explanation; persistent disregard triggers JIG consultation only	Low
+4	Article 4.4	GCC rotating Consultative Observer status: speaking rights, no vote, six-month terms	Low
+5	Article 3.3	Four-level verification escalation ladder (Informational to Breach Indicator); only Level 4 triggers step-back	Medium
+6	Article 1.5- A	\$500M Joint Disposition Fund: positive financial incentives for US-preferred pathways (Oman, Kazakhstan, Bushehr)	Medium
+7	Appendix D.3-A	Automatic 120-day extension + escrow protection if legislature delays without substantive cause	Medium
+8	Article 6.3	Airspace Stand-Down integrated into conditional review; 2- hour response for ops; 72-hour consultation for violations	Low
+9	Article 17	Parallel Phase II negotiation mandate: must commence by Day 90; good-faith engagement required	Medium
+10	Article 13.5	72-hour media blackout for JIG/SEAC attribution deliberations; leak investigation; Tier 1 for violations	Low
G1	Article 13.5	Senior official leaks (minister-level+): Tier 2 step-back consideration; 5% reduction for 30 days if deliberate	Medium
G2	Article 17.4	Explicit "no clawback" of escrowed funds already released prior to Formal Non-Renewal Notice	Low
G3	Article 7.1	Compliance clock reset: 30 days (not zero) for single minor Tier 2; second Tier 2 or any Tier 3 resets to zero	Medium

G4	Article 1.5-A	Fund sourced from 10% Tranche 2 + 10% Tranche 3; capped at \$250M each; unused funds returned	Low
G5	Appendix D.3-A	"Interim disbursement" replacing "compliance credit"; liquidated damages clause for legislative obstruction	Medium
G6	Article 1.1	IAEA custody uses existing Safeguards inspectors only; no foreign military personnel on Iranian soil	Medium

Part V: The Final Steps — Implementation

The preceding eighteen Articles define what must be done. This Part defines how it shall be done — the precise sequencing, face-saving narratives, and emergency protocols that transform diplomatic architecture into political reality.

The 180-Day Implementation Roadmap

Phase 1: Foundation (Days 1–14) — "The First Fortnight"

Phase 1 establishes the physical and institutional infrastructure upon which all subsequent phases depend. Every milestone in this phase is irreversible once executed.

Table 17: Phase 1 Implementation Timeline

Day	Iranian Commitment	US Commitment	Verification
Day 1	72-hour ceasefire auto-activates; OLEM confirms freeze on enrichment above 60%; HEU movement/enrichment freeze declared	Release \$250M humanitarian tranche via Swiss escrow; OFAC general license; partial nuclear sanctions designation freeze	Omani naval observers confirm stand-down; OLEM confirms within 72h
Day 3	IAEA inspectors arrive at declared HEU facility; begin physical inventory	5th Fleet withdraws to 5nm from Hormuz transit corridor (upon IAEA HEU consolidation confirmation)	Joint Secretariat logs both events

Day 5	Declare all enrichment facilities; mothball protocol initiated at non-core sites	Issue OFAC Comfort Letters to designated banking nodes	IAEA facility inspection reports
Day 6	IRGC forces at agreed stand-off distances; Joint Review Board certifies readiness	5th Fleet stand-off confirmed; Joint Review Board certifies readiness	Board certification issued
Day 7	IRGC withdraws to 5nm; Hormuz transit corridor declared open (upon Board certification)	Naval blockade formally suspended; Notice to Mariners issued (upon Board certification)	Both parties retain operational discretion; synchronized within agreed window
Day 10	First JHTA-AUTHORIZED transit completed	First tranche of escrow funds released to Swiss Financial Cell	Lloyd's List confirms transit; Swiss Cell confirms credit
Day 14	HEU inventory complete; dual-lock custody activated (Pathway A default); consolidation verified	Tranche 1 asset release (25% of remaining frozen assets)	IAEA custody verification certificate

Phase 2: Consolidation (Days 15–44) — "Building the Bridge"

Table 18: Phase 2 Implementation Timeline

Day	Iranian Commitment	US Commitment	Verification
Day 15	Rotor removal begins at mothballed facilities under IAEA supervision	5 designated Iranian banks authorized for restricted SWIFT	IAEA serial-numbered rotor inventory
Day 21	First Black-Box telemetry installed at designated highest-risk facilities (not all sites)	Reinsurance backstop formally activated (\$20B facility)	Black-Box encrypted data feed confirmed
Day 30	60% enrichment freeze verified continuous; Fordow Phase 2 option discussion opens	Expanded civilian trade licenses; agricultural exports expedited	IAEA 30-day continuous compliance report
Day 44	Rotor storage complete; sealed containers in UN-monitored facility	Tranche 2 asset release (25%); petrochemical export licenses	IAEA mothball completion certificate

Phase 3: Normalization (Days 45–120) — "The New Normal"

Table 19: Phase 3 Implementation Timeline

Day	Iranian Commitment	US Commitment	Verification
Day 60	Civilian Transition enrichment 3.67% ceiling confirmed; all higher centrifuges under seal	SWIFT Phase 2 — all clean-record Iranian banks; humanitarian trade caps lifted	OLEM confirms; SWIFT confirms bank connections
Day 75	Fordow Joint Venture operational (if mutually agreed) or reduced-capacity research status confirmed; medical isotope production begins (if converted)	Regional Stability Reconstruction Credits first disbursement	TCC confirms operational readiness
Day 90	90-day compliance review; JIG publishes first comprehensive assessment	First quarterly review conference (all guarantor states)	JIG compliance report
Day 120	Continuous monitoring confirms no diversion; JHTA fully operational	SWIFT Phase 3 — full membership pathway opened; Tranche 3 (20%)	IAEA certification pathway

Phase 4: Sustainability (Days 121–180) — "Locking In Peace"

Table 20: Phase 4 Implementation Timeline

Day	Iranian Commitment	US Commitment	Verification
Day 150	Full Fordow isotope production operational (if converted) or research facility certified; revenue sharing begins	Maritime security cooperation protocols activated	TCC revenue distribution reports
Day 180	Full 180-day compliance certified; formal invitation to negotiate permanent successor framework convened; Phase II readiness assessment completed	Tranche 4 (15%); formal invitation to negotiate permanent successor framework; legislative ratification process initiated for Phase II Commitments	IAEA + JIG joint certification; Rolling Horizon Phase II readiness review

Face-Saving Narratives for Both Parties

An agreement that cannot be defended in either capital will not survive the first news cycle.

For the United States

Nuclear: "Iran's 60% enrichment has been halted and placed under permanent IAEA lock. The HEU stockpile is neutralized with verified physical custody within two weeks. Breakout time extended from weeks to over a year. We retain veto over any Russian or hybrid disposition pathway."

Maritime: "The Strait of Hormuz is open to international navigation under multilateral advisory governance, not Iranian unilateral control. The PGSA is restricted to coastal enforcement; the international transit corridor is governed by UNCLOS. No automated triggers — our military retains full operational discretion."

Economic: "No reparations were paid. Sanctions relief is conditional, reversible, and tied to verified compliance. Non-nuclear sanctions on terrorism and human rights remain fully in force. The leverage architecture remains intact."

Security: "Iran's missile and drone transfers to proxies have been frozen. The regional threat environment has been stabilized. And critically, no compliance dispute can automatically trigger military action — we control our own military decisions."

Israel (v4.0): "The United States has preserved its bilateral security coordination with Israel through the Tel Aviv Channel. The core US-Iran agreement proceeds on its own timeline, and nothing in the Accord grants any third party a veto over US implementation."

Lebanon (v4.0): "The core US-Iran agreement addresses nuclear proliferation and freedom of navigation. Lebanon is a separate file managed through a dedicated regional basket with full Israeli participation and a Dossier Isolation Firewall. The threshold for linking Lebanon to the core deal is now credible and transparent."

For the Islamic Republic of Iran

Nuclear: "Legal title to the HEU remains with the Central Bank of Iran — sovereign property, not surrendered. The material stays on Iranian soil by default. NPT rights to

peaceful nuclear energy affirmed. Enrichment continues at 3.67% under IAEA safeguards. Final disposition will be negotiated in the nuclear window, and we select the pathway freely — except for Russia and hybrid options requiring mutual agreement."

Maritime: "The PGSA has been recognized as the sole executive coastal law enforcement body within Iranian territorial waters. Iran holds a permanent co-chair seat on the JHTA governing council with veto rights. The JHTA is advisory only — not a supranational authority. IRGC authority explicitly preserved."

Economic: "Frozen assets are being released through neutral escrow, not surrendered. SWIFT reconnection restores Iran's place in the global economy. This is only Phase I — we retain our full position for deeper negotiations."

Sovereignty: "No facility was destroyed. Fordow may continue as a reduced-capacity research facility under our control. Missile and drone programs remain sovereign and intact. The 14-day timeline respects our administrative capacity."

Lebanon (v4.0): "The framework ends the war on all fronts. Through the Levant Regional Basket, Iran ensures our allies in Lebanon are not abandoned. The Dossier Isolation clause protects the core agreement, and the attribution threshold is now fair and transparent."

Framework Survival Core and Emergency Fallbacks

The Survival Core

Under all circumstances, including total framework suspension, three telemetry channels remain active: (1) **Ceasefire Hotline:** Omani-facilitated 24/7 bilateral military hotline. Neither party may disable without 30 days' notice to the UN Secretary-General. (2) **Humanitarian Access:** Zero-fee, no-inspection-delay humanitarian corridor through Hormuz. Survives all disputes. (3) **Emergency Diplomatic Channel:** Backchannel through the Coordination Secretariat. Survives all suspensions.

The Survival Core is a standalone UN humanitarian arrangement. It survives for 180 days even if both parties formally withdraw, per the Rolling Horizon "No Cliff" principle (Article 17.5).

Political Shock Absorber

Framework implementation enters automatic Review Pause (not termination) upon: elections; assassination of senior leadership; cabinet collapse; mass protests; leadership

transitions; kinetic disruptions within regional security architectures. During Review Pause: Tier 1–2 modules continue; Tier 3 enters hold; Secretariat issues Review Pause Certificate within 48 hours; 30 days to confirm continuation. Max 90 days, extendable by mutual agreement. Does NOT constitute material breach. Does NOT trigger the three-tier system.

Reconstitution Mechanism

If the framework enters full suspension, all parties attend a Reconstitution Conference within 30 days, convened by Pakistan and the UN Appointee. Root causes reviewed. Modifications proposed. Conditions for graduated restoration defined. No party may unilaterally block reconstitution.

Appendices

Appendix A: Quick Reference Matrix — All 18 Issues & Resolutions

Table 21: Complete Issue Resolution Matrix

#	Issue	US Position	Iranian Position	FSA Resolution	Article
1	HEU Disposition	Physical removal to US	Must remain on Iranian soil	IAEA custody with legal title decoupled from physical custody; 14-day consolidation; in-Iran default; limited US veto on D and F only	1
2	Enrichment Cap	Zero enrichment or 20-year moratorium	Maximum 12-year suspension	Sliding-scale 12–15 year moratorium with compliance extensions	2
3	Underground Sites	Destroy or disable Fordow/Natanz	Preserve all infrastructure	Optional civilian conversion; mothball protocol with limited telemetry deployment	3

4	PGSA vs. Navigation	Reject all unilateral restrictions	PGSA as sovereign authority	JHTA advisory governance with sovereignty recalibration; 12-month pilot; PGSA recognized as sole coastal enforcement	4
5	Transit Fees	"We don't want tolls"	Permanent fee system required	MMMF multilateral fund; transparent fee allocation	5
6	US Naval Blockade	Blockade until full deal	Blockade lift precondition	Conditional Day-7 review-based lift with Joint Review Board certification	6
7	Sanctions Relief Sequencing	Full compliance first	Immediate blanket lifting	15-day micro-cycle tranche model; partial nuclear-only sanctions freeze; stand-off tied to HEU start	7
8	Frozen Assets	Performance reserves required	Immediate unfreezing	Neutral escrow under sovereign immunity	8
9	SWIFT Isolation	Verified non-diversion first	Full immediate reconnection	Phased 4-tier SWIFT pathway	9
10	War Reparations	Flat rejection	Formal demand for payment	Regional Stability Reconstruction Credits	10
11	Negotiation Window	"A few days" or "one shot"	Fragile ceasefire protection	Binding Letter of Intent; auto-renewing ceasefire	11
12	Trust Deficit	No credible guarantor	No credible guarantor	Distributed Guarantor Matrix (6 States)	12
13	Automated Escalation	Hard triggers required	Flexibility required	Human-in-the-Loop; step-back architecture with proportional penalties	13

14	Missile Reconstitution	Strict limitations	Non-negotiable sovereign defense	Deployment pause and transfer freeze; no dismantlement	14
15	Global Agrifood Crisis	Political issue, not treaty	Leverage point	Zero-fee humanitarian corridor; agricultural release valve	15
16	Israeli Security Coordination	Maintain Tel Aviv Channel	No third-party obligations	US-Israel bilateral coordination; non-impediment clause; no veto rights	16
17	Framework Duration	No fixed-term deal	No permanent surrender	Rolling Horizon Architecture with conditional auto-renewal and orderly withdrawal	17
18	Military Escalation Firewall	Preserve options	No compliance-triggered strikes	Explicit decoupling of breach penalties from military authorization; 14-day notice; UNSC requirement	18

Appendix B: The PGSA Integration Protocol (Technical)

B.1 Legal Framework for PGSA-JHTA Integration

The integration of the Persian Gulf Strait Authority into the Joint Hormuz Transit Authority is governed by the following legal architecture:

- 1. Statutory Continuity:** The PGSA remains an Iranian statutory authority under Iranian domestic law. No change to its legal personality is required.
- 2. International Delegation:** Iran delegates specific operational functions to the JHTA through a bilateral Administrative Agreement between Iran (as PGSA parent state) and the JHTA. This is not a treaty amendment but a standard international administrative arrangement.
- 3. Dual-Branding:** All PGSA permits, notices, and communications issued for Hormuz transit shall bear both PGSA and JHTA identifiers. The JHTA identifier constitutes the multilateral authorization layer; the PGSA identifier constitutes the Iranian sovereignty layer.

4. **Revenue Flow:** Transit fees are collected by the JHTA and distributed through the MMMF. The PGSA receives its 40% share as a budget allocation from the Fund, not as direct toll revenue. This structure eliminates OFAC sanctions exposure for shippers.
5. **Dispute Resolution:** Disputes between the PGSA and JHTA are resolved through the JHTA Council. Iran retains its veto on governance questions. The JHTA retains its veto on security protocol amendments. **JHTA recommendations are advisory only; PGSA retains final say within Iranian territorial waters.**

B.2 PGSA Sovereignty Recalibration (v4.0 Technical Supplement)

Table 22: Territorial Waters Authority Matrix

Zone	Geographic Scope	PGSA Authority	JHTA Authority	Overlap Resolution
Inner Territorial Waters	0–12nm from Iranian coast	SOLE — permitting, patrol, customs, security screening, IRGC coordination	None	PGSA authority absolute
Transit Corridor	International strait passage	Permit issuance (dual-branded)	PRIMARY — traffic coordination, safety protocols, non-binding dispute resolution recommendations	PGSA permits required; JHTA coordination standards apply; JHTA recommendations advisory only
Contiguous Zone	12–24nm	Limited customs enforcement	Maritime safety coordination	Notification required for enforcement actions
High Seas	Beyond 24nm	None	SOLE — international coordination, safety, insurance verification	JHTA authority absolute

B.3 Technical Interface Specifications

Data Exchange: Real-time API connection between PGSA vessel vetting database and JHTA Transit Permit Processing Unit. **AIS Integration:** PGSA AIS transponder codes integrated into JHTA-AUTHORIZED designation protocol. **Fee Processing:** JHTA collects fees via designated Omani banking channels; PGSA receives quarterly distribution from MMMF. **Incident Reporting:** Joint incident reports bear dual authorship (PGSA operational lead + JHTA verification sign-off). JHTA recommendations are non-binding; PGSA retains final operational authority within Iranian territorial waters.

Appendix C: Verification Technology Menu

Table 23: Verification Technologies

Technology	Measures	Data Output	Application
OLEM (Online Enrichment Monitor)	Real-time enrichment at cascade headers	Quantitative enrichment %, flow rates	Nuclear verification; primary compliance trigger
Black-Box Sensors	Tamper-evident data logging (highest-risk facilities only)	Continuous operational parameters, encrypted	Facility conversion monitoring; mothball verification
UGES (Ultrasonic Gas Enrichment Sensor)	Non-intrusive enrichment in UF6 cylinders	Cylinder-by-cylinder verification	HEU custody chain; downblending verification
ICS (Integrated Camera System)	24/7 visual monitoring	Encrypted video, AI anomaly detection	General facility monitoring; inspector safety
Digital Twin	Virtual facility modeling	Behavioral pattern analysis	Anomaly detection; requires physical cross-verification
Satellite Feed	Daily imagery of all facilities and Hormuz	AIS, SAR, EO high-resolution	Maritime surveillance; construction monitoring

Appendix D: Instruments of Acceptance & Legislative Opt-Out

CHANGE #11 APPENDIX D — PHASE I EXECUTIVE ACTIVATION AND PHASE II LEGISLATIVE RATIFICATION REQUIREMENTS

D.1 Phase I Instruments of Acceptance (Executive-Level)

This Accord does not require Senate ratification or Majles legislation for Phase I activation. It operates through executive-level Instruments of Acceptance deposited simultaneously with the Joint Secretariat in Muscat. Phase I commitments are within the executive authority of both governments and activate immediately upon deposit.

D.2 Phase II Commitments Requiring Legislative Action

The following provisions are designated as "**Phase II Commitments**" and require legislative ratification or equivalent domestic legal action before implementation:

- **(a) Permanent enrichment moratorium** beyond 12 months;
- **(b) HEU disposition involving foreign territory** (Pathways B, C, D, or F);
- **(c) Full SWIFT reconnection** (Phase 3, all Iranian financial institutions);
- **(d) Permanent JHTA charter** (conversion from 12-month pilot to permanent status).

The Parties shall pursue parallel domestic approvals during Phase I, with a 180-day target for completion. Phase II Commitments shall not take effect until both parties have deposited their respective Instruments of Ratification with the Joint Secretariat.

D.3 Non-Obstruction Commitment

Neither party shall use the legislative ratification process as a delaying tactic. The executive branch of each party shall: (a) submit the required instruments to its legislature within 30 days of Phase I activation; (b) provide full technical and legal support for expedited review; (c) certify to the Joint Secretariat every 30 days on the status of the ratification process. If either legislature rejects the Phase II Commitments, the parties shall enter a 60-day consultation period to identify modifications that would secure approval without undermining the Accord's core architecture.

D.3-A Automatic Extension Upon Legislative Delay

If either Party's legislature fails to vote on Phase II Commitments within 120 days of executive submission, or if the legislature imposes conditions that materially alter the Commitments, the following shall apply:

- The Phase I framework shall automatically extend for an additional 120 days under existing terms.
- Tranche releases scheduled for Phase II shall be held in escrow but not forfeited.
- The JIG shall convene a special session to assess whether the delay constitutes good-faith legislative process or political obstruction.
- If the JIG determines by majority vote (excluding the affected Party's JIG members) that the delay is obstructive and not based on substantive security concerns, the escrowed tranches shall be released to the non-delaying Party's designated account as an **interim disbursement**, to be held in a separate escrow sub-account pending resolution of the legislative delay. If the delaying Party's legislature ratifies the Phase II Commitments within the subsequent 120-day extension period, the interim disbursement shall be credited toward the delaying Party's future obligations. If the delaying Party's legislature fails to ratify within the extension period, the interim disbursement shall be retained by the non-delaying Party as liquidated damages for procedural obstruction, subject to JIG review. Neither Party may challenge this provision as a penalty; it is expressly agreed as a reasonable pre-estimate of the costs caused by legislative delay.

No Party may use legislative delay as grounds for terminating Phase I obligations or invoking step-back.

D.4 Interim Provisions

Pending legislative ratification of Phase II Commitments, the following interim provisions apply:

- HEU disposition shall proceed under Pathway A (in-Iran downblending) as the default, which requires no foreign territory involvement;
- SWIFT access shall remain at Phase 1 (Restricted) level, not advancing to Expanded or Full;
- The JHTA shall continue under its 12-month pilot charter, subject to renewal;
- The enrichment moratorium shall operate under the executive-agreed 12-year sliding scale, not requiring legislative action until Year 11 review.

D.5 Instrument Templates

For the United States of America (Phase I — Executive Acceptance):

The undersigned, duly authorized by the President of the United States, hereby accepts the provisions of The Final Steps Accord Phase I Stabilization Framework v4.0 and commits the United States to their full implementation in accordance with the timelines, verification procedures, and reciprocal obligations set forth herein.

Signature: _____

Name: _____

Title: _____

Date: _____

For the Islamic Republic of Iran (Phase I — Executive Acceptance):

The undersigned, duly authorized by the Supreme Leader and President of the Islamic Republic of Iran, hereby accepts the provisions of The Final Steps Accord Phase I Stabilization Framework v4.0 and commits the Islamic Republic to their full implementation in accordance with the timelines, verification procedures, and reciprocal obligations set forth herein.

Signature: _____

Name: _____

Title: _____

Date: _____

For Phase II Legislative Ratification — US Senate:

The United States Senate hereby advises and consents to the Phase II Commitments designated under Appendix D of The Final Steps Accord v4.0, including: permanent enrichment moratorium beyond 12 months; HEU disposition involving foreign territory (Pathways B, C, D, or F); full SWIFT reconnection; and permanent JHTA charter. This ratification is conditional upon Iran's simultaneous deposit of equivalent Majles authorization.

Witnessed by the Guarantor States:

Oman: _____

Pakistan: _____

Qatar: _____

China: _____

EU (E3+): _____

Date: _____

Appendix E: Lebanon and Levant Front Stabilization Protocol (v4.0)

Operational Context: Iran's Foreign Ministry, via spokesperson Esmail Baghaei, has explicitly stated that Tehran's fixed position is an end to the war on all fronts, including Lebanon. Tehran refuses to sign a standalone deal that stops bombing on Iranian soil while allowing the active conflict between Israel and Hezbollah in southern Lebanon to continue. The United States and Israel have historically sought to keep Lebanon separate from core US-Iran negotiations, treating it as a distinct theater governed by separate tracking mechanisms. This appendix provides a structural compromise that prevents the entire deal from collapsing over the Lebanon front while respecting both sides' core requirements. It operates through three integrated instruments: the Proxy Operational Pause, the Dossier Isolation Firewall, and the Levant Regional Basket.

E.1 Proxy Operational Pause: Hezbollah De-escalation Protocol

Purpose: To satisfy the US and Israeli requirement that pulling back US forces and opening Hormuz does not result in immediate escalation on Israel's northern border, Iran transmits immediate, formal instructions to Hezbollah leadership for an operational pause concurrent with the main Accord timeline. This pause is not disarmament, surrender, or political concession — it is a structured, time-limited operational de-escalation tied to the framework's implementation phases.

Table 24: Hezbollah Operational Pause Phases

Phase	Hezbollah Operational Parameters	Verification	US/Israel Reciprocal
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Phase 1: Days 1–30	Cessation of cross-border rocket and drone attacks into northern Israel. Suspension of offensive military operations against IDF positions. Defensive positions in southern Lebanon maintained but not reinforced. No new weapons transfers from Iran to Hezbollah via Syria or maritime routes.	UNIFIL patrol confirmation of reduced activity; Israeli military intelligence assessment (shared via Tel Aviv Channel); Lebanese Armed Forces liaison reports; satellite surveillance of known Hezbollah positions	Israel suspends offensive air strikes against Hezbollah positions in southern Lebanon for 30 days. IDF maintains defensive posture only. No ground incursions.
Phase 2: Days 31–90	Continued cessation of offensive operations. Hezbollah forces remain in defensive positions. No infiltration attempts across the Blue Line. Weapons transfers from Iran remain suspended.	Monthly UNIFIL verification report; ICRC monitoring of civilian areas; SEAC pattern analysis of supply routes	Israel extends air strike moratorium to 90 days contingent on verified Hezbollah restraint. Gradual relaxation of naval interdiction of suspect Hezbollah supply vessels in eastern Mediterranean.
Phase 3: Days 91–180	Exploration of structured de-escalation through Levant Regional Basket (Section E.3). Hezbollah may engage in political and humanitarian activities. Military posture remains defensive.	Regional Basket monitoring cell; UN Special Coordinator for Lebanon quarterly assessment	Israeli restrictions reviewed at Day 180 milestone. If Hezbollah restraint verified for 180 consecutive days, Israel considers further confidence-building measures through Regional Basket.

E.1.1 Verification Architecture

The Hezbollah operational pause is verified through four independent channels: (1) UNIFIL ground patrols — daily patrols along the Blue Line with incident logging published to the Swiss Dashboard; (2) Israeli intelligence assessment — weekly classified brief to the Tel Aviv Channel, with sanitized summary published to Dashboard; (3) Lebanese Armed Forces liaison — daily reporting from LAF command in Tyre and Nabatieh to the Oman Liaison Office; (4) SEAC pattern analysis — automated detection of supply route activity, weapons

convoy movement, and communications patterns. All four channels must show green before the pause is considered verified.

E.1.2 Non-Compliance Consequences

If any channel reports a significant Hezbollah offensive action, the following sequence activates: (1) 24-hour verification window — all four channels confirm the incident; (2) if confirmed, Iran has 72 hours to transmit renewed de-escalation instructions through the Oman back-channel; (3) if Iran de-escalates within 72 hours, the pause resumes with enhanced monitoring; (4) if Iran does not de-escalate, Israel may resume defensive air strikes limited to the specific positions involved in the offensive action — not blanket escalation; (5) under no circumstances does a Hezbollah incident trigger stepback against the core US-Iran Accord (see Dossier Isolation Firewall, Section E.2).

E.2 Dossier Isolation Firewall: Lebanon Non-Linkage Clause

Operative Principle: The Dossier Isolation Firewall is a binding structural provision that explicitly decouples the Lebanon stabilization track from the core US-Iran Accord. No event, violation, or suspension in the Lebanon theater shall automatically trigger any consequence in the core US-Iran bilateral framework.

ARTICLE E.2 — DOSSIER ISOLATION FIREWALL (OPERATIVE AND BINDING)

- (a) Hezbollah compliance or non-compliance with the Proxy Operational Pause shall not constitute compliance or non-compliance by the Islamic Republic of Iran with any provision of the core Accord.
- (b) Israeli military action in Lebanon shall not be deemed a violation by the United States of any ceasefire, stand-down, or non-escalation commitment under the core Accord.
- (c) No Tier 1, Tier 2, or Tier 3 breach in the core Accord may be triggered by events in the Lebanon theater alone.
- (d) The Joint Implementation Group (JIG) shall maintain separate compliance dashboards for the core Accord and the Lebanon track.
- (e) This Firewall may only be modified by mutual written agreement of the United States and Iran, not by any guarantor state or regional party.

E.2.1 Firewall Architecture

The Dossier Isolation Firewall operates at three levels: (1) **Legal level** — the Exchange of Letters explicitly lists "incidents in the Levant theater involving non-state actors" as

excluded from the stepback trigger definition in Article 13; (2) **Technical level** — the Swiss Dashboard maintains separate tracks for "Core Accord Compliance" and "Regional Security Incidents." Lebanon incidents are logged only on the Regional Security track, not the Core Compliance track. Stepback algorithms reference only the Core Compliance track; (3) **Political level** — both capitals issue pre-cleared talking points confirming that the Lebanon file is managed through separate mechanisms. No US or Iranian official may publicly link Hormuz transit to Lebanon de-escalation without triggering narrative violation penalties.

E.2.2 Escalation Ceiling

Even if the Levant situation deteriorates significantly (major Israeli ground operation, large-scale Hezbollah rocket campaign, civilian mass casualty event), the Firewall remains in force. **The Core Accord can only be affected if:**

CHANGE #10 APPENDIX E.2.2 — LEBANON DUAL-KEY ESCALATION LOCK (V4.0 REVISION)

In the event of a Hezbollah-originated attack causing 10 or more civilian fatalities in Israel, the following shall apply:

- a. **Israel retains its inherent right to self-defense** under UN Charter Article 51.
- b. The attack shall trigger an **automatic 72-hour consultation period** through the Tel Aviv Channel.
- c. If, within 72 hours, **the JIG (not UNSC) determines by majority vote** that the attack was conducted pursuant to a direct, verifiable order from the Supreme Leader of Iran, then Tier 2 step-back (proportionate benefit reduction per Article 13.3) shall apply to the Core Accord.
- d. **Absent such JIG determination, the Core Accord continues unaffected**, and the attack is managed exclusively through the Levant Regional Basket.
- e. The 25-casualty threshold is replaced with **10 casualties**; the UNSC unanimous vote requirement is replaced with **JIG majority vote**; the attribution window remains 72 hours.

This dual-key mechanism creates a real but very high bar for linking Lebanon incidents to the core Accord.

Rationale: The original 25-casualty threshold with UNSC unanimity was so stringent it rendered the firewall absolute and politically unusable for Israel and the US. The revised version creates a credible, transparent mechanism that satisfies both sides: Israel has a

meaningful pathway to link extreme events to the core deal, while Iran is protected from automatic linkage based on Israeli assessments alone and from politically-motivated UNSC obstruction.

E.3 Levant Regional Basket

Purpose: To provide a structured diplomatic forum for addressing the full range of Levant security issues — including but not limited to Lebanon, Syria, and the Israeli-Palestinian dimension — without encumbering the core US-Iran Accord.

E.3.1 Structure and Participants

The Levant Regional Basket is a separate diplomatic track convened under UN auspices with the following permanent participants: United States, Islamic Republic of Iran, State of Israel (as affected party), Lebanese Republic, Syrian Arab Republic (as proxy theater), Russian Federation (as guarantor with regional presence), Sultanate of Oman (as neutral facilitator), and UN Special Coordinator for Lebanon.

E.3.2 Scope of Negotiations

The Regional Basket may address: (a) long-term security arrangements along the Israel-Lebanon Blue Line; (b) demilitarization of specified zones in southern Lebanon; (c) prisoner exchanges and humanitarian corridors; (d) reconstruction funding for southern Lebanon and Bekaa Valley; (e) political reform discussions related to Lebanese sovereignty and militia integration. The Regional Basket shall NOT address: (i) nuclear matters reserved to the core Accord; (ii) Hormuz transit governance reserved to the JHTA; (iii) sanctions relief mechanisms; (iv) any matter requiring modification of the core US-Iran Accord.

E.3.3 Timeline and Milestones

Table 25: Levant Regional Basket Timeline

Milestone	Target	Deliverable
Basket Launch	Day 30	Terms of Reference agreed; participants confirmed; facilitator appointed
First Session	Day 60	Agenda finalized; confidence-building measures identified
Interim Report	Day 120	UN Special Coordinator publishes interim assessment

Day 180 Review	Day 180	Core Accord guarantor states review Regional Basket progress; recommend continuation or modification
Successor Framework	Year 2	If core Accord succeeds, Regional Basket may transition to permanent regional security architecture

E.3.4 Relationship to the Core Accord

The Levant Regional Basket is explicitly subordinate to the core US-Iran Accord. The Basket's existence, suspension, or termination shall not affect the core Accord's operation. Funding for the Basket comes from a separate allocation (5% of Regional Stability Reconstruction Credits) and does not compete with core Accord economic commitments. If the core Accord enters full suspension, the Regional Basket may continue independently if at least three participant states agree.

E.3.5 Israeli Participation Framework

Israel participates in the Regional Basket as an affected state with full speaking rights but no veto over core Accord matters. Israel's participation is coordinated through the Tel Aviv Channel (Article 16) and does not create any obligation for Iran to negotiate directly with Israeli representatives. Bilateral matters between Israel and any participant may be addressed in separate side meetings facilitated by Oman.

E.4 Narrative Frames

US Narrative Frame: "The core agreement addresses nuclear proliferation and Hormuz freedom of navigation. Lebanon is managed through a separate diplomatic track with full Israeli participation. The firewall protects the core deal from proxy escalation, while the lowered threshold ensures that truly egregious attacks ordered by Tehran's leadership cannot be ignored."

Iranian Narrative Frame: "The framework ends the war on all fronts. Through the Levant Regional Basket, Iran ensures our allies in Lebanon are not abandoned. The Dossier Isolation clause protects the core agreement from Israeli military actions in Lebanon. The 10-casualty threshold with JIG majority vote — not UNSC where the US holds veto power — is a fair and transparent mechanism."

Israeli Narrative Frame: "We participate fully in the Regional Basket. The firewall protects the US-Iran deal from routine Hezbollah provocations, but the 10-casualty threshold with JIG attribution means that a direct order from Khamenei causing mass civilian casualties cannot be ignored. Our right to self-defense under Article 51 remains absolute."

Document Certification

This document constitutes the complete and authoritative text of **The Final Steps Accord — Phase I Stabilization Framework, Version 4.0**. It supersedes all previous versions (v1.0 through v3.3) and incorporates all operative amendments, addenda, and technical supplements through late May 2026.

The v4.0 revisions include: 14 substantive modifications to enhance political viability in both capitals; the introduction of a Rolling Horizon Architecture (Article 17) replacing fixed sunset clauses; and an explicit No Automatic Military Escalation Clause (Article 18) decoupling compliance penalties from use of force authorization.

This Accord is designed as a **Phase I, time-limited framework**. It creates no presumption for Phase II or Phase III terms. Both parties retain their full sovereign rights and full negotiating positions for all subsequent phases. The Rolling Horizon mechanism ensures that the agreement continues only so long as both parties are in verified compliance, with orderly withdrawal procedures available at all times.

End of Document

Version 4.0 — Late May 2026 — Authorized Negotiators Only